

PMP® EXAM PREP GUIDE

OUTWITTING THE PMP® EXAM

Based On PMBOK® Sixth Edition **+ AGILE**

Apply 100s Of Tips, Tricks And Strategies And Don't
Be Among The 55% Who Fail On Their First Attempt



Asif Chorwadwala, PMP, SSGB

PMP® Exam Prep Guide

Outwitting

The PMP® Exam

100s Of Tips, Tricks And Strategies.

Don't Be Among The 55% Who Fail PMP®
Exam On Their First Attempt

Based On PMI's PMBOK 6th Edition +
AGILE

(PMP Exam Starting From March 26, 2018)

Published by: IDAX InfoTech, Ltd.

Author: Asif Chorwadwala, PMP, SSGB

<http://www.linkedin.com/in/asifchorwadwala>

Contact: support@outwittingthepmexam.com

Copyright: 2018

Edition: Updated based on PMI's PMBOK 6th Edition + AGILE

Limit of Liability/Disclaimer of Warranty: The publisher and the author make no representations or warranties with respect to the accuracy or completeness of the contents of this work and specifically disclaim all warranties, including without limitation warranties of fitness for a particular purpose. No warranty may be created or extended by sales or promotional materials. The advice and strategies contained herein may not be suitable for every situation. This work is sold with the understanding that the publisher is not engaged in rendering legal, accounting, or other professional services. If professional assistance is required, the services of a competent professional person should be sought. Neither the publisher nor the author shall be liable for damages arising here from. The fact that an organization or Web site is referred to in this work as a citation and/or a potential source of further information does not mean that the author or the publisher endorses the information the organization or Web site may provide or recommendations it may make. Further, readers should be aware that Internet Web sites listed in this work might have changed or disappeared between when this work was written and when it is read.

Disclosure: Some links in this book are affiliated links.

Trademarks: PMI, PMP, CAPM, PMBOK® Guide, PgMP, Project Management Institute, and the R.E.P. trademarks and logos are registered marks of Project Management Institute, Inc.

Don't let PMI® know about this book ;)

Table of Contents

[*Acknowledgment*](#)

[*Preface*](#)

[*Introduction*](#)

[**Part – I: FOR PMP CERTIFICATION**](#)

[*Making The Case For PMP Certification*](#)

[*2 ½ Months Study Plan*](#)

[*Pick Perfect Bootcamp For 35 Contact Hours*](#)

[*SWOT Analysis For PMP Certification*](#)

[*28 Winning Habits Of “The Super Successful” PMPs*](#)

[**Part - II: FOR PMP EXAM**](#)

[*Blueprint Of The PMP® Examination*](#)

[*Preparing For The PMP Exam – 10 Myths*](#)

[*Read This Cheat Sheet By K.A. Just 2 Hours Before The Exam*](#)

[*Must Bring Items To The Exam Center*](#)

[*Want To Fail? Do These 10 Little Things*](#)

[*Sure Shot 50 Question Types In The Exam*](#)

[*23 Dirty Little Tricks During The Exam*](#)

[*Magic Formula To Solve Multi-Choice Questions In Exam - 8 Step Approach*](#)

[*PMP Exam Revision Table AND TEMPLATE*](#)

[*How To Crack PMP Exam In 2 ½ Hours*](#)

[*Action Items Check List*](#)

[*Free Online Question Banks And Resources*](#)

[**Final Words**](#)

[*Review/Feedback/Online Game Link*](#)

Acknowledgment

My efforts have been encouraged in the recent past by a number of influential people in my life, all through whose efforts this guide has come to be. I cannot ignore the constant encouragement accorded me by my sweet beloved wife, whose foresight has always made me aspire to do great things in life.

Finally, my sincere gratitude to all the thousands of [PMPBest Yahoo Group Members](https://groups.yahoo.com/neo/groups/pmpbest/info) (<https://groups.yahoo.com/neo/groups/pmpbest/info>) and all who have been able to discuss this in other forums worldwide for helping me in the formulation and successful creation of this book. Their insights and experiences as they prepared for the exam formed the core and basis upon which this work was implemented.

Good luck in acquiring your PMP Certification!

Thanks & Best Wishes,

Asif Chorwadwala, PMP, SSGB

<http://www.linkedin.com/in/asifchorwadwala>

Preface

This edition of book is a pioneer in providing lasting solutions to an unending quest by students all over the world in finding a simpler way of passing the PMP exam.

Being a PMP Certified Professional myself, I understand what students have gone through in their quest to pass this test, and therefore take it upon myself to offer my assistance. There were so many enquiries, interviews and consultations on best practices to pass the PMP Exam with forum members in particular from PMPBest Yahoo Group, and a lot more such forums.

Though it took a long time for me to consolidate the bits and pieces, the work eventually paid off since this is one of the simplest strategy guides that you will ever refer to pass your PMP exam. The bits and pieces that got consolidated into this book are students lessons learned, a idea or trick that worked, an approach that changed failure into success, a study plan that fit the situation, a habit that triumphed and more. The summary and the manner in which the fragments were put together if anything to go by makes it an exclusive book, one that will become every student's most trusted companion as they face the PMP exam, and eventually ace them.

Introduction

Receiving is good but giving is much better. Nevertheless, sharing is the best. With that said, I would like to share a downloadable copy of lessons learned by PMPs who shared their experience to help PMP aspirants like you:

==> Download Link: <http://outwittingthepmexam.com/lessonslearned/>

Do not forget to visit Rita Mulcahy's Online Process Group Game developed and customized just for you to practice putting right task into right Process Group. This is exclusive to the reader of this book. Refer to special link in the last pages of this book's Review/Feedback section.

You deserve more than a pat on the back for taking your time to study for and actually sit for the Project Management Institute (PMI®) Project Management Professional (PMP®) Certification Exam. A lot of students have thought about it but never really come through with the decision. Therefore consider yourself to have made a great career changing decision.

This book has been written with the view of helping you study for your PMP exam and passing it. This does not mean that it is to act as a substitute guide to what is recommended in the syllabus. The main purpose of this book is to make sure that you find it easy to get through the exam with ease by planning well for your time, and doing the right things that will set you in the right direction within as short a time, and without stressing yourself too much. That is why we call "Outwitting (aka outsmarting) The PMP Exam".

In as much as there are so many articles or blogs that have in the recent past been released that cover several topics, you can rest assured that this book is as a matter of fact more than that. The amount of research that has been put into this book is not from fictional characters, but from more than 12,000 individuals who have had an experience with the PMP exam. This therefore means that the illustrations in this book are as real as can be, and you can surely relate to them. Their contribution to the development of this book have been effectively tested, and satisfactorily approved as a guideline with which this book can be written. I thank them all for their efforts.

There are two sections in this book:

- For PMP Certification
- For PMP Exam

For PMP Certification

This section covers the topics that will play a major role in making sure that you accomplish your PMP Certification. There are a number of highlights that are covered in this section, including the following:

- Giving you an insight into why the PMP program is beneficial to you
- Guiding you on how to plan for the certification. A 2 ½ months study plan
- Help you identify an institution where you can get the 35 contact hours
- Conduct a SWOT analysis of your choice in relation to the PMP Certification
- 28 Winning Habits Of The Super Successful PMPs (**A must read**)
- And many more

For PMP Exam

This section covers all you would like to know about the PMP Exam. This is very important as it enables you ease off the pressure of studying too hard. Some of the contents that are covered in this section include:

- Preparing for the exam
- Things not to do in the exam
- Exam Cheat sheet (**A must read**)

- How to answer questions
- 23 Dirty Little Tricks during the exam chapter can reduce the time it takes for the preparation as well as time to pass the exam into half. **(A must read)**
- Exam Revision Template
- Online Process Game Link
- And many more

The chapters in this book have been made precise and direct enough so that you can make good use of all the material as you seek your certification.

For best results, Susan Wise Bauer (a famous author, writer, instructor, and founder) said read each book three times. First time, read for facts; then evaluate them; finally, form your own opinion. Forming your opinion is a must. In that way you are the judge to decide to follow what is in the material or refer to some other book. She also said there are some books to be tasted, others to be swallowed, and some few to be chewed and digested. This book is for you to chew and digest if you want to pass the PMP Exam quickly and with ease.

Sole purpose of this book is to help PMP aspirants like you pass the exam in shortest and easiest way. Time is as important to you as anything else in your quest to pass such exams. Therefore without taking up more of your time, flip over and begin your journey to success!

If you are short of time, I would say **do not miss these three chapters: Cheat Sheet, 28 winning habits** of The Super Successful PMPs and **23 dirty tricks** during the exam. This will reduce your time for preparation and time to complete the exam into half.

Hope these insights give you some light

Part – I: FOR PMP CERTIFICATION

CHAPTER

Making The Case For PMP Certification

If you have taken some time and checked out the top project management advertisement jobs in the recent past, you may have realized that for every 20 jobs advertised, 12 of them require or demand a Project Management Certification. This survey is especially so on CIO.com and Dice.com. Besides that, you will also realize that all of these jobs are for mid-level to senior-level IT project management, and the experience required for the same is nothing less than 5 years in the industry.

A PMP Credential is highly regarded for most of these jobs adverts, and gives you an edge above the rest in the event that you are applying for the same. A recent study by The Standish Group CHAOS reports has revealed that two thirds of CIOs hold a PMI certification in high regard. Therefore in the event that you would like to get employed and succeed in this field, you are strongly advised to get a PMP Certification.

Is PMP Certification for me?

There are so many excuses that people come up with in an attempt at avoiding the PMP Certification. Some of the most common ones are:

- PM is less methodological than it is people skill oriented
- There is no point in doing it without the backing of my employers
- PMP is heavy on resources, time and money in particular
- The exam isn't a fair representation of real life PM skills
- Stringent requirements
- You can do without it

- It is less effective for an individual as compared to a company
- Recommended for government projects only
- You do not plan on changing employers any time soon
- You know all there is to know, and so far you are doing just fine
- Practicability is highly unlikely

These are just but lame excuses that people come up with in order to avoid the PMP Certification. However, you should realize that if you are to succeed in your career, retain a high level position or get promoted to one, a PMP Certification is a must.

What are the advantages that you stand to benefit from getting a PMP Certification?

- It is sufficient proof of your competence in Project Management
- It certifies not only that you have spent enough hours learning about project management, but also that you are well versed with the experience
- It makes showcases your ability and makes you stand out from the crowd
- Forms a huge stepping stone in your career in as far as advancing is concerned
- Gives you firsthand knowledge of how to manage your personal life
- Gives you experience that is applicable worldwide, making you employable throughout the world
- By passing the exam and being certified, you stand a higher chance of getting a pay raise or even a bonus for your expertise and experience. Besides that, you also have a better shot at

promotion within the same company

- The PMP designation also acts as a guarantee to your employers of what you can do and the impact that you can have in fast tracking results
- So many companies today require project managers to have the PMP certification in order for them to retain their status in the company, and a lot more have been promoted as a result of the certification

If you are still looking for more reasons as to why you need to take the PMP Certification exam, you can rest assured that you will find as many as you would like to get, but these are the main ones that will impact on your life significantly. However, the underlying fact here is that a PMP Certification does change your life in so many ways for the better, hence the need for you to attempt it especially if you want to get ahead of the pack.

Get yourself that PMP Certification!

CHAPTER

2 ½ Months Study Plan

Back in the schools and colleges, students carry out a lot of memorization to be able to pass the exams. However, with a PMP exam things are a little different. The knowledge that is tested here is very practical, and relies on how much you actually know and can apply in real life. All this is done according to the PMBOK Guide issued by the PMI®.

One of the major challenges that so many people face today is that they have not really had the kind of experience that is required for PMP. This is because a lot of them have taken charge of smaller projects, and those who have been Project Managers have not really had that opportunity for a time long enough to get some experience.

With such an experience, you can understand why a lot of first time PMP exam takers rarely make the cut for the pass grade. This is also as a result of the fact that so many of them might be knowledgeable, but only in limited areas because the smaller projects are not so engaging, and therefore they will still lack the knowledge for bigger tasks.

Before you decide to prepare for a PMP exam, you should already understand that the exam process is very involving, and your plan has to be highly effective. This means that your plan should be practical and achievable within a predetermined time frame. Most importantly, you should be ready to see out the plan to the end!

Over time many PMP aspirant have managed to make it in the PMP exam for one reason, following this simple plan that I carved out for them:

1) PMP Certification Application Form

Go to the PMI (<http://www.pmi.org>) website and fill up the PMP Certification Application form. Once that is done, you will have to wait at least a week for the code with which you will schedule an exam at the [prometric website](http://www.prometric.com/PMI/default.htm) (<http://www.prometric.com/PMI/default.htm>).

After all, you do want to pass it in your first attempt. It is not a low price ticket and you are probably stealing time away from your family, so get it right the first time.

2) Pick the day of exam and stick to it

This is probably one of the most important tasks that you will have to think of. The reason for this is because it gives you a target to work towards, and failure to do so might render all your efforts fruitless.

3) Create a definite study plan

As soon as you have your PMP certification exam date, the next thing that you should think of is to calculate the number of days remaining, and then accommodate your study plan with that wisely. The use of a good study plan is to make sure that you are not ambushed by the exams. This is by allowing you time to read, understand and even go over some mock PMP exam questions.

Once you have your plan in action, you could also think in terms of getting the <http://ezclick.me/pmpbooks>, or some of the PMP exam preparation material available. One of the best guides is the [Kim Heldman's PMP Study Guide](#), which is one of the easiest to understand. This guide gets you step by step into the world of Project Management. I would start with this and then PMBOK and then [Rita Mulcahy's PMP Exam Prep Book](#) which is another good read, all of which you can find at [Amazon](#) or a bookstore around you.

4) PMP Exam Preparation Workshop

Either you enroll to your local PMI chapter or private training institute or study online. For PMI local chapters, you can most certainly find one PMP Training Directory if you need assistance. PMI has local chapters in major cities in almost each country, so you can ask the local PMI chapter for assistance, recommendations or suggestions of upcoming PMP boot camps.

These boot camps are around 5 – 6 days in length, and are quite intensive.

Some even run in the weekends either 6 weekends with one full day every week or 2 half days on Saturdays and Sundays. I would recommend weekend classes so you don't have to take leave from your busy project schedule. The scheduling of these camps are in such a way that the coverage is limited to 2 content areas daily according to the [PMBOK](#), all the way from the Introduction through to the Exam Strategy and Q/A sessions.

In the event that you are not able to make all these processes fit into your schedule, there is also another alternative, which is bound to work even better for you, study online. The good thing about this method is that you are in a position to actually study within your own convenience levels, from time to location. Apart from that you are also entitled to [35 Contact Hours, or PDUs](#) all of which are allowed for the PMP exam.

By this time you are so close to the end result that you should not even have a negative thought in your mind. You have to be committed to the plan, and be ready to see it through till the end. One of the easiest ways of doing this is to share your ideas with those close to you; friends, family, or even your spouse. The reason for this is so that they can be able to appreciate your commitment to the cause, and actually support you through it to the end. It is no wonder they say in life success comes only to those who are willing to perspire more than they are able to inspire, hard work does pay!

5) Gauge the gap in your knowledge

There are a number of questions that you should ask yourself about the PMP exam that will help in finding out how big a knowledge gap you have in the project management framework. These include:

- Which areas aren't you more knowledgeable?
- Which process group have you been a passive participant?
- Which is the toughest knowledge area for you?
- What professional and social ethics prevail around your work place or country?
- Do you feel there is a difference in your understanding and the best practices?

Once you are able to answer these questions, it will be easier for you to figure out just how much more work you are required to do to be ready for the PMP

certification exam.

Daunted by the thought of studying for the exam? Fear not! This table will help you plan your study and break down your study time into smaller, more achievable goals. For example: By the first week you will be done by all the nitty-gritty things for the PMP exam and will have good understanding of PMP exam contents. Suddenly your goal seems a lot more attainable, doesn't it? We hope this table helps you organize your study sessions, keep track of your progress, and inspires you to keep going.

Suggested PMP Exam Study Plan:

Assuming that you have at least 2 ½ months before the exam, and you would like to spend your time wisely for the preparation of the exam, I would recommended below time schedule and study material that has been proven and tested. You might be reading same book couple of times, so make sure you underline important sentences in your first read and only read underlined lines in the subsequent reads to speed up your study. This plan assumes you are willing to spend 4 hours each day, either 4 hours at a stretch or break in into 2 hours in the morning and 2 hours in the evening (2-2) or 1 hour in the morning, 1 hour in the afternoon and 2 hours in the evening (1-1-2) each day, whichever is convenient.

Materials required during the study plan:

[PMI's PMBOK http://ezclick.me/pmpbooks](http://ezclick.me/pmpbooks)

[Rita Mulcahy's PM Exam Prep](#)

[Rita Mulcahy's Hot Topics Audio](#)

[Kim Heldman Project Management Study Guide](#)

[Any Question Bank \(http://pmbootcamp.org\)](http://pmbootcamp.org)

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
Week 1	April 1 st	Submit Application Form Read PMBOK Glossary (Page 695 - 726) Join online Yahoo and Google groups for PMP Exam	Listen to Rita Mulcahy's Hot Topics Audio daily
	April 2 nd	Read Kim Heldman's PMP Study Guide	This will give you over all good idea about project management, flow of activities and any process you had not experienced earlier.
	April 3 rd	Read Kim Heldman PMP Study Guide	"
	April 4 th	Read Kim Heldman PMP Study Guide	"
	April 5 th	Read Kim Heldman PMP Study Guide	"
	April 6 th	Read Kim Heldman PMP Study Guide	"
	April 7 th	Read Kim Heldman PMP Study Guide	"
Week 2	April 8 th	Read PMBOK This will give you good idea about PMP Exam and your level of expertise. Remember to do just a quick read at this time. Underline important points.	Part 1 - Chapter 1 Introduction Part 1 - Chapter 2 The Environment in which Projects Operate
	April 9 th	Read PMBOK	Part 1 - Chapter 3 The Role of the Project Manager Part 1 - Chapter 4 Project Integration Management
	April 10 th	Read PMBOK	Part1 - Chapter 5 Project Scope Management Part 1 - Chapter 6 Project Schedule Management

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
	April 11 th	Read PMBOK	Part 1 - Chapter 7 Project Cost Management Part 1 - Chapter 8 Project Quality Management
	April 12 th	Read PMBOK	Part 1 - Chapter 9 Project Resource Management Part 1 - Chapter 10 Project Communications Management
	April 13 th	Read PMBOK	Part 1 - Chapter 11 Project Risk Management Part 1 - Chapter 12 Project Procurement Management
	April 14 th	Read PMBOK	Part 1 - Chapter 13 Project Stakeholder Management, Appendix and Glossary Professional Responsibilities from PMI Website/Handbook
Week 3	April 15 th	Read PMBOK Part 2	Part 2 – Chapter 1 Introduction Part 2 – Chapter 2 Initiating Process Group
	April 16 th	Read PMBOK Part 2	Part 2 – Chapter 3 Planning Process Group Part 2 - Chapter 4 – Executing Process Group
	April 17 th	Read PMBOK Part 2	Part 2 – Chapter 5 – Monitoring and Controlling Process Group Part 2 – Closing Process Group
	April 18 th	Read PMBOK Part 2	Part 2 – Appendix X1 - Changes Skip Appendix X2 - Contributors Part 2 – Appendix X3 – Project Environments Part 2 - Appendix X4 – K.A.
	April 19 th	Read PMBOK Part 2	Part 2 – Appendix X5 - Tailoring K.A. Part 2 – Appendix X6 – Tools and Techniques

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
	April 20 th	Read PMBOK Agile	Agile – Chapter 1 - Introduction Agile – Chapter 2 – An Introduction To Agile Agile – Chapter 3 – Life Cycle Selection
	April 21 st	Read PMBOK Agile	Agile – Chapter 4 – Implementing Agile - Creating Agile – Chapter 5 – Implementing Agile - Delivering Agile – Chapter 6 – Organizational Considerations
Week 4	April 22 nd	Read PMBOK Agile	Agile – Chapter 7 – A Call To Action Annex A1, A2, A3 Appendix X1 (skip), X2, X3 Glossary, Definitions
	April 23 rd	Chapter 1 - Introduction	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	April 24 th	Chapter 2 - The Environment in which Projects Operate	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	April 25 th	Chapter 3 The Role of the Project Manager	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	April 26 th	Chapter 4 - Integration	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
	April 27 th	Chapter 4 - Integration	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	April 28 th	Chapter 4 - Integration	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
Week 5	April 29 th	Scope	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	April 30 th	Scope	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 1 st	Scope	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 2 nd	Schedule	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 3 rd	Schedule	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 4 th	Schedule	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
	May 5 th	Cost	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
Week 6	May 6 th	Cost	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 7 th	Cost	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 8 th	Quality	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 9 th	Quality	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 10 th	Quality	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 11 th	Resources	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 12 th	Resources	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
Week 7	May 13 th	Resources	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 14 th	Communications	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 15 th	Communications	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep p Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 16 th	Communications	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 18 th	Risk	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 19 th	Risk	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 20 th	Risk	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
Week 8	May 21 st	Procurement	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
	May 22 nd	Procurement	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 23 rd	Stakeholder	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 24 th	Stakeholder	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 25 th	Professional Responsibilities	PMI Website, Handbook PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 26 th	Professional Responsibilities	PMI Website, Handbook PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 27 th	PMBOK Part 2	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
Week 9	May 28 th	PMBOK Part 2	PMBOK (only underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 29 th	PMBOK Agile	PMBOK Agile (underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
	May <u>30th</u>	PMBOK Agile	PMBOK Agile (underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	May 31 st	PMBOK Agile	PMBOK Agile (underlined points) PMP Exam Prep Create Cheat Sheet Practice Questions
	June 1 st	Read & Brain Dump All Chapters Cheat Sheet	Brain Dump like you would do in the exam
	June 2 nd	Read & Brain Dump All Chapters Cheat Sheet	Brain Dump like you would do in the exam
	June 3 rd	Full Test	There are many free or paid tests available that you can use to access your level of understanding, speed of answering and depth of knowledge.
Week 10	June 4 th	Concentrate on Weak Areas	
	June 5 th	Concentrate on Weak Areas	
	June 6 th	Concentrate on Weak Areas	
	June 7 th	Full Test	There are many free or paid tests available that you can use to access your level of understanding, speed of answering and depth of knowledge.
	June 8 th	Go through Cheat Sheets, Glossary, Flash Cards	
	June 9 th	Skim (read summary/notes) from PMP Study Guide (Kim Heldman)	First Half
	June	Skim (read	Second Half

Week	Day	Action	Remarks
	10 th	summary/notes) from PMP Study Guide (Kim Heldman)	
Week 11	June 11 th	Full Test	There are many free or paid tests available that you can use to assess your level of understanding, speed of answering and depth of knowledge.
	June 12 th	Skim (read summary/notes) from Rita Mulcahy's PMP Prep	
	June 13 th	Skim (read summary/notes) from Rita Mulcahy's PMP Prep	
	June 14 th	Read PMBOK Underlined Points	
	June 15 th	Read PMBOK Underlined Points	
	June 16 th	Read Cheat Sheet Final Test	

Depending on your specific needs, you can alter this as suitable. Once tabled, stick to it.

CHAPTER

Pick Perfect Bootcamp For 35 Contact Hours

The fact that there are so many institutes that purport to be able to assist you in getting ready for your PMP Certification makes it very hard to pick the perfect boot camp. There are so many of these, which at a reasonable rate can get you ready for the PMP exam. When you are working with a local chapter, you should rest assured that there is a dedicated team of individuals who are more than happy to get you in the PMBOK way. The only problem is that there is never a guarantee as to the end result that you will actually make it. This is solely up to you and how much effort you are willing to put into the whole exercise.

Here are a few pointers that will show you how to select an organization that can assist you in getting ready for your PMP® exam:

1) 35 Contact Hours

The most critical point here is you should enroll in the course that has minimum of 35 hours of training and other activities. Check with the institute if they will be providing a certificate that mentions how many contact hours you have gained during the course. Some institutes provide less than 35 contacts hours of training. Make sure you enroll to 35 contact hour's course or the remaining from some other activities or courses. You won't qualify to register for PMP Exam if your contact hours are less than 35.

2) Since when are they providing Project Management training?

The PMP® boot camp is in great demand today with tens of thousands of people desiring the certification. For this reason there are so many institutions that have come up in the recent past to cash in on this need. It is therefore important that you find out how long the institution has been around so that

you are able to make a wise choice. Having been around for a long time means that the institution is not just after your money but are fully committed and knows the development of PMBOK.

3) Count the experienced trainers

This is very important especially when you are thinking of having whole teams of employees undertake a PMP course. Try and avoid institutions that are merely run by one person, since in most cases they do not have the resources that will benefit you in the long run

4) Are they in just for PMP or for Project Management courses as well?

The whole idea behind this is to be able to find an organization that will offer you not just what you require, but a lot more that you can also make good use of in terms of Project Management models and theories. Apart from this, it might also mean that the institution is indeed committed to the PMP scheme, and they are not just out to get money from you. This therefore means that they are out to educate you as much as they can, and also instill into you the principles required in project management. It is even better because in the event that you are asked questions that are slightly unrelated to the course, you should be in a better position to respond to the same. Such institutions also guarantee you that you will be taught by professionals who will not just teach you, but also share vital information about project management with you from their experience.

5) Are they associated with reputable organizations that source the services to teach project management and PMP® Exam Boot Camps?

The importance of this is that it gives you the guarantee that you are being taught by professionals. This is because the only way through which reputable organizations would partner with them is if they are the best. Reputable organizations that you should look out for include government agencies and privately run companies.

6) What is their percentage of first time passing?

This is one of the most honest ways of finding out just how good the

institution is. A lot of the institutions will always indicate that their students have more than a 90% pass rate on their exams. However, what they do not indicate is whether this is on the first attempt, second or the third. Try and make sure that these indices indicate a pass rate for students taking their first exam before you can enroll with them.

7) Mode and materials of training provided

This is more about planning, and for you to take this course you already understand the importance of the same to your career. You should have information on a few issues regarding the way in which the classes are going to be structured. This means that you should think in terms of materials provided, the mode of teaching, whether there are breaks in the system or not, how many knowledge areas are covered, whether there are practice tests offered to get you ready for the real exam, and so forth.

8) Type of guarantee:

Beware of the boot camps that encourage you to try them out, and if you are not satisfied you can come back for free. In most cases these are not really worth the attention. You should try and focus on an institution that offers PMBOK® to the widest of scopes, and also offer you a guarantee that you will surely pass the PMP® test in the long run. If this is not the case, the best thing that you can do is to simply walk away before it is too late.

9) Do they pay for your repeated exam?

In the event that you do not pass the PMP® exam on your first attempt, how far is the institution willing to go to make sure that you pass it? There are number of institutions that will allow you to come back for free boot camp sessions, but do not pay for your other tests. However, there are many institutions that offer free training and pay the exam fee on your second and third attempt. Therefore you should try and find an institution that guarantees you to get you the PMP Certification.

10) Teaching techniques and personal interactions

The fact that the persons who have enrolled for the PMP® boot camp are

adult means that there is some level of respect that they do command. Therefore through the class interactions, there are teaching techniques that are recommended. As a student, there is some dignity that you do command from your trainers, and you have to make sure that this is maintained. It is important to go over and understand the teaching style because failure to do so would leave you susceptible to intimidation in the event that things do not work out as you had hoped.

You have to be very wary of institutions that are fond of Socratic teaching for example. This is because a lot of people find it demeaning, and can be a real hindrance to morale boosting. As a matter of fact, institutions that have this kind of teaching method always have a high rate of people dropping out altogether. The reason for this is that it always has a way of making the students look stupid.

However, you should be open to institutions that allow you to interact freely with the trainer and other students, and share what you have in mind without feeling like someone is looking down on you. Even when you do not know something, you might have a slight idea. Therefore it is important that you are encouraged to add more knowledge onto what you already know instead of being made to look out of place. One of the ways of doing this might be to pair you with another teacher or students who are well versed in those areas, and you can share the information you have.

It is therefore very important that you find yourself a good provider for a PMP® boot camp if you really hope to achieve success as soon as possible.

When you use the guidelines set above, you are sure to find a provider who cares not just for your money, but seeks to make sure that you pass your exam and get the certification you so desire. One of the most important things that you should not overlook is the fact that in whichever means that you use, you have to make sure that you are comfortable with the system, as this is the only way through which you will be able to go along with the system and eventually pass and get the PMP® certification.

CHAPTER

SWOT Analysis For PMP Certification

Just as is the case with any business, war, or challenge, you must first of all understand the weaknesses and strengths that lie within so that it gets easier for you to conquer your quest. In most cases, the major hindrance of achieving success lies within yourself, and the faster you deal with this, the better for you. To be able to move on, you should conduct a **SWOT** analysis

A SWOT analysis simply analyzes the **Strengths**, **Weaknesses**, **Opportunities** available and **Threats** to the realization of the core objective. Advanced by Albert Humphrey between the 60s and the 70s with data from Fortune 500 companies, this method has become a very important part of the world of business, as we know it today.

How is a SWOT analysis important to you? Well, as you prepare for your PMP certification, this analysis will enable you realize your strong points to maximize on them, weaknesses so you can find ways of dealing with them, opportunities you can take advantage of, and threats that you should be wary of, and ready to tackle in the event that you are caught unaware.

Here's how a SWOT analysis will help you achieve PMP certification:

- Based on your experience in the field, you will be able to make use of your experience as a strong point and use it as a relevant case study upon which to build your knowledge for the exam
- By understanding your weaknesses, you should be able to realize what you need to work much more on, and make attempts at ensuring that you achieve this.
- Taking advantage of opportunities is a very important aspect of all business related fields. In this case therefore, you should also be able to realize where these lie, and take advantage of them. Whether it is your highly experienced tutor or your study partner, you should make good use of resources that have been laid ahead of you.

- There are threats that you should run away from, while there are some that you should embrace and find ways of turning them into opportunities. As a matter of fact, overcoming a threat in many ways turns them into opportunities or strengths. Therefore if you have so many threats, you can only imagine how stronger you will become when you overcome them.
- A SWOT analysis defines a desired end result first before embarking on anything else. This therefore forms a building block for Strategic Planning, a subject of a lot of research today.
- **Strengths:** particular characteristics of the business or team that give it a competitive advantage over others in the industry.
- **Weaknesses:** are characteristics that place the firm at a competitive disadvantage relative to others within the industry
- **Opportunities:** *external* chances to make greater sales or profits in the business environment.
- **Threats:** *external* elements in the environment that could cause trouble for the business, most of which are beyond its control

The importance of SWOT analysis is that it is through the same that you will come up with sufficient steps to plan for the achievement of your goals. From the SWOT analysis, you will ascertain whether your objectives are realistic and achievable, if not you have to come up with another one and repeat the process until you are satisfied.

One of the major highlights of SWOT analysis is that it is the most common way of coming up with development areas, hence its importance.

Use of SWOT analysis

Though a lot of people are of the misconception that a SWOT analysis would only work in profit making organizations, this is never really the case. It is a vital step in any form of decision-making, especially where the realization of the desired objective involves some commitment of funds. From crisis management to coming up with recommendations in a survey, profit and nonprofit taking institutions, government units and individuals all find good use of SWOT analysis.

For most businesses, this analysis is the best way of realizing market gaps, creating niches and successfully managing them. Applying the same knowledge in your life off the office, a SWOT analysis would come in handy for your career since it gives you the tools you require to take advantage of your abilities, specific talents and opportunities, and even threats too.

It also allows you the conceptual freedom to maximize on your strong points while taking advantage of all the opportunities that lay ahead of you. Apart from that, you also get to learn of threats and how to minimize them, or minimize their impact on your life (career)

So how do you make use of SWOT analysis to achieve PMP Certification?

Personal SWOT Analysis

Personal success can be achieved only when you make good use of your talents, and understand your weaknesses too, and manage them adequately.

Through SWOT analysis, it is therefore possible for you to find out ways of identifying, analyzing and coming up with ways of dealing with your strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats.

The main advantage that you stand to gain when you run a SWOT analysis is that to realize that major gains can be achieved by recognizing the small things in your environment. By simply understanding your weaknesses, it is possible for you to eliminate threats around you, and even turn some of them into strengths.

It is also a way of making yourself stand out from the crowd, by eliminating those peers that bring you down, and anything else that stands between you and success.

How to Use the Tool

Below worksheet can aptly assist you in coming up with an effective SWOT Analysis:

Strengths What do you do well? What unique resources can you draw on? What do others see as your strengths?	Weaknesses What could you improve? Where do you have fewer resources than others? What are others likely to see as weaknesses?
Opportunities What opportunities are open to you? What trends could you take advantage of? How can you turn your strengths into opportunities?	Threats What threats could harm you? What is your competition doing? What threats do your weaknesses expose you to?

Strengths

- What kind of advantages (anything from skills to certification or even professional connections) do you possess relative to other people?

- What project management level do you excel in best?
- Do you have any personal resources, things like prior PMPs, project management experience, or even project lead
- What does your boss and other people consider your strongest point in project management?
- What is the highlight of your Project Management career, and can you relate to it as the proudest moment?
- What values do you stand by that others fail to exhibit which you can relate with PMI's professional responsibilities?
- Do you have influential persons in your network?
- How prepared are you for the exam? Do you have all the materials, question banks, cheat sheets and prerequisite necessary?

When doing this, consider your perspective, and that of those who matter around you. As a matter of fact, do not withhold any information. However, if you are not able to do this with ease you could consider listing characteristics that stand out as your personal strengths. That may also be helpful.

Weaknesses

- What PM tasks do you avoid because you do not feel you are up to task?
- As a project manager, what do those around you see as your weak point?
- Do you have any negative work habits, maybe lateness, inability to deal with stress, anger management issues?
- In as far as your skill level and education are concerned, where do you fall short?
- Any personal traits that hinder your development as a project manager? You could be afraid of public speaking or something else
- How much time can you set aside for studying after work or

during the weekends?

- Can you set aside 35 contact hours as recommended by PMI for the PMP exam?
- How much study material do you have?
- Is your PMP question bank sufficient?
- In prime areas, do your fellow workers outshine you?

When filling out this part too, be sure to consider your ideas and those of other persons too. This is because there are other weaknesses that people might see which you do not. The importance of this is that it allows you to be able to anticipate your weaknesses as early as possible.

Opportunities

- Is there any new project management strategy that you can make good use of? Apart from that, can you learn from someone off the Internet?
- If you are in a growing industry, how can the certification benefit you in relation to your industry?
- How strategically oriented is your network of connections, and can they advise you as necessary for the exam?
- Can you realize and take advantage of trends in your company?
- Can you realize and take advantage of the mistakes that a member of your competitor network is making?
- What needs are there in your company that need to be met but no one is doing that?

Have your clients ever complained about projects being mishandled in your organization? If this is the case, can you offer them a solution after you get PMP certified?

There are so many ways through which you can get opportunities and take advantage of them too. These include:

- Attending conferences, educational classes and networking events

- In the event that a colleague of yours is going on leave, can you take some of their projects and make a name for yourself?
- Take an active role in a project that will require you to learn new skills

One other thing that you can do is to consider your personal strengths, and consider whether they can assist you in passing the PMP exam. On the same note, an evaluation of your weaknesses is also very important since through the same you can work around your weaknesses to turn them into worthy opportunities.

Threats

- Are there any impediments to your current working situation?
- Is there competition for roles and projects from your colleagues?
- Consider your job and the demand for the work that you do, are there any changes?
- Is your position under threat from improvement in technology?
- Are some of your weaknesses potential threats?

When you have conducted this survey of yourself, you will be in a good position to understand what is required of you, and how you can go about it too.

A Personal SWOT Example

If you have gone through this and are still not sure of how to go about the whole SWOT assessment, here is an excerpt from Jane, a project assistant to guide you through.

Strengths

- I have the ability to impress clients and the company at large more than my project manager, due to my intelligence.
- People within my team and customers always appreciate my knack for communication
- When I need a particular answer, I tactfully ask the right questions

- Nothing pleases me more than the successful completion of projects under my watch, hence my commitment to the same
- I am well prepared for the PMP exam, with all the material, question bank, cheat sheet
- In my network there are a number of PMPs whose insight can be of great help as I head for the exam

Weaknesses

- The quality of my work at times takes a beating due to the fact that I always want to complete everything so fast and clear my “to do” list
- When I am faced with a lot of tasks, my desire to complete them all in good time weighs me down in the amount of resultant stress
- I have big problem with making presentations and sharing ideas to clients. This is because of my fear of public speaking
- I have fallen short of the 35 contact hours

Opportunities

- One of our major competitors does not know how to meet the needs of smaller clients
- There is a huge project management conference next month, and I look forward to the strategic networking, not forgetting the seminars that will follow
- Our project manager will be going away on academic leave for a while. I see this as a great opportunity for me to step into her shoes and push for my ideas to shine

Threats

- I am competing for the same project manager position with Nick, a colleague who is much better at public speaking than I am
- My creativity has been negatively affected by the fact that there have been staff shortages, and I feel overworked.

- Our company is bowing to the brunt of the economic crisis, and slow growth might force us to lay off more workers

After realizing all this, Jane takes the initiative and speaks to Nick about the project manager's academic leave, and brings up the idea that they could share the responsibilities and work together exploiting both their strengths. Nick is open-minded and accepts her proposal. As a matter of fact, he mentions how impressed he is with her creativity and intelligence, which he has always considered a threat to his presentation ability.

The two of them actually do come up with a strategy to meet the needs of the smaller clients, and make them feel a lot better than their competitor does, hence taking advantage of their competitor's weaknesses.

Therefore it is possible for you to use SWOT analysis to your favor and get through the PMP exam.

CHAPTER

28 Winning Habits Of “The Super Successful” PMPs

Throughout my career, I have had the chance to interact with people who did not just attempt, but actually managed to pass the PMP exam on their first attempt. Now, **they themselves are trainers and teachers** (Gurus) teaching PMP aspirants. In the course of my interactions with them, there are a number of things that I have come to learn of how they managed to make it through. As a matter of fact most of them managed to go to their daily work routines and also study for the exam, and still aced it on their first attempts. For that reason I call them “The Super Successful” PMPs. One thing that I noticed about them all is that they did have some traits that indeed propelled them to success. It is these that I will share with you today, and hope to inculcate the same spirit in you to make you succeed.

1) Desire

Each of us has their own desire, with which they set goals and come up with a plan to achieve the same. Nobody has the power to determine your desire for you. Therefore it is up to you to see what you would want to achieve in life, and how the PMP certification can assist you with this

A burning desire for excellence is one of those things that will push you to study even harder and take every possible opportunity that comes your way, just to make sure that you will pass the exam. For you to therefore pass this exam, you must have that drive within you.

2) Clarity is Essence

Clarity does go a long way in ensuring that you achieve success. With a clear mind in the exam, you should be able to think straight, and answer the questions with a level of insight that someone whose mind is not clear would not be able to. As a matter of fact, this eases off all kinds of confusion and

frustration that you might have in you.

3) Identify your constraints

Constraints are those things that will hold you back in your attempt to succeed. Someone said very nicely “If you don’t fix your own constraints first then you will find a way to sabotage your system, guaranteed.” One of the best ways of dealing with constraints is to first of all recognize them, and then overcome them. Nobody is perfect. There might be some constraints that you cannot take care of. Perfection is a long shot for so many people and for this reason you should always try and make sure that you go to the exam fully aware of what you can and what you cannot do perfectly. It is okay if you cannot answer some questions. You do not have to score 100%. This is a good way of managing time.

4) Approach Your Exam Strategically

Going for the PMP or any other exam is like going to war, you must always have a strategy, and one that works at that. Having a strategy for the exam is one of the surest ways of making sure that you will tackle the questions as they come, and deal with them appropriately.

5) Develop a complete study plan

In the event that you ever sat for an exam and failed, it does not mean that you are a flop. As a matter of fact all that this means is that you simply failed to get your strategy right. Therefore the best way of coming back into an exam that you failed before as a matter of fact is to make sure that you come up with an all-inclusive study plan.

A good study plan is not just something that you will follow, but it is the key to your success. This will assist you in spending as much time as required on a particular study area. It is very important that you not just share your time equitably, but reasonably on the different study areas that you are to cover in preparation for the exam.

6) Manage Your Time Well

Time management is very important, whether you are studying or if you are

in the exam. In the exam this will ensure that you do not spend more time than necessary on questions that you should spend a few minutes or even seconds on. In the long run, it also goes a long way in ensuring that you do not just finish your test in time, but spare a few minutes to go over and make a few corrections here and there.

7) Use Travel Time Productively

While commuting to work place or college, use your travel time wisely. Always make sure you have cassettes/cd/iPod playing in your car or headphone. This will help you to spend your time wisely and pass the exam sooner.

8) Know Your Peak Hours

The importance of knowing your peak hours is so that you can get to know when you understand whatever you are studying best. It is therefore important that you focus more on studying when you have a higher retention capacity. This way when you go for the exam you will have an easier time remembering what you did.

9) Temporary Defeat

In life you have to be ready to deal with things as they are thrown at you. Exams as a matter of fact have a way of throwing all sorts of weapons at you. The biggest question is how are you going to deal with it?

The secret, for any exam and the PMP exam in particular is to never give up! The moment you decide to quit, that's the moment you accept a lifetime of failure.

No man is ever whipped, until he QUITs—in *his own mind*.

10) Set Standards of Performance

As you prepare for the exam, you should already have in mind how far you are willing to go. This means that you should already know how you could perform. However, at times this is never really enough. What will get you through however is by setting attainable and realistic performance standards, and working so hard to make sure that you get there.

11) Ally yourself with group

You would not really make any headway if you are going in the opposite

direction with the rest of the class. As you study and prepare for the PMP exam, you should never align yourself further from the group. It is not a bad thing to have different ideas, so in the event that you have these, feel free to communicate and share with the rest of the class, and most importantly your tutor. This is the only way through which you will remain in focus and in tandem with the rest of the class.

12) Learn from experts

Well, this is one of the most common things to do in the world today. How else would someone learn better than being an apprentice of some of the best people at what they do? For your PMP exam, you will need to consider finding out as much as possible about those who have managed to succeed in this sphere. This way, you can at least have a figure to look up to, which means you will not just succeed in the exam, but also in life.

13) They Never Quit

Failure should not be taken as an excuse to quit as many people do. The fact that you have failed an exam does not mean that you will never be good at it. As a matter of fact it gives you more than enough impetus to come back stronger. Therefore if you have ever attempted the exam and failed, do not throw in the towel just yet, try and take the bull by the horns.

14) Learn from your failures

Failure should not be seen as a weak point, but a chance for you to learn a lesson and do something about it. This is more or less why people conduct a SWOT analysis, to be able to turn the threats and weaknesses into opportunities and strengths in the long run. Do not shy away from your failures, especially if you sat for and failed the exam in the first place. What you should do is to take some lessons from it and build up on that for the future.

15) Study in a Blue Room

We all know studying can be stressful and include anxiety in even the calmest of students. That is why blue is the best color to study around. Blue has been known to soothe your eyes, reduce blood pressure and decrease anxiety. That leads to a better studying environment because you are relaxed and better able to focus on studying. You will feel less stressed and more

confident in your studying ability, which can make all of the difference in a test. If you haven't study in blue room, try and see. You don't have to paint your house or your study room. Try surrounding yourself with blue blanket partitions. Believe me, it works.

16) Spread Your Studying

None of these tips to help you study will be that effective if you cram them all into one night. According to a concept called the testing effect, memory is enhanced when you test yourself right after learning material rather than days or weeks later. In a study, participants who were tested 1 day after learning had a better long-term memory than those who were tested 7 or 21 days later. You can apply this to your studying by testing yourself the night you learn material in class. By constantly studying your materials as you learn them, you will place all of your info into your long-term memory and better remember them on your exams.

17) Believe in Yourself

If you believe you can pass or you believe you cannot pass, you are right. People really overestimate the impact confidence can have on an exam. In psychology, there is something called the self-fulfilling prophecy. It states that the predictions we make about ourselves can actually influence our behavior and cause those predictions to come true. In other words, if you think you won't do well on an exam, it will lead you to not do well. Know that you are fully able to study and ace an exam, and it will cause you to do better on an exam. Confidence is key in everything you do in life.

18) Understand How You Study

Every individual learns differently. Knowing the conditions under which you study best will help you most effectively learn and retain information that you need for your exam.

For example, if you know that you need absolute silence to concentrate on the material you need to learn, you can either study in a library or in a quiet room at home. You may also be someone who needs a little noise or commotion to help you focus.

”Multitasking” is a myth. While you might think you’re able to watch TV, text your friends, and study for exams at the same time, your brain simply can’t handle that many competing streams of information. Give yourself some quiet, dedicated study time, and leave the other stuff for your leisure time.

19) Prioritize Your Study Time

Aim to study everything but devote more time to things you don't understand or know less well. Figure out Knowledge Areas you are most weak in and devote the most study time to them. By doing this you will optimize your study time and help ensure that you pass your test. It sounds obvious, but it's surprisingly hard to do. Why? Because we like doing easy things—so our tendency, when we revise, is to concentrate on the things we already know. If you're not sure what your weaker subjects are, ask your trainer or look at the test practice. Prioritizing weak subjects also goes back to understanding the marking scheme. Let's assume you are appearing for your school exam and your examination involves you writing three essays. Most likely they will carry equal marks. Even if you know two subjects off by heart and get perfect marks, if you can't write a third essay you risk losing up to a third of the marks. So weak subjects will have a disproportionate effect on your total mark, dragging your overall grade down much more. That's why you should give weak subjects most focus.

20) Switch up your study spots

Studies suggest that changing your environment after spending a long time studying in one place can help improve your brain’s retention. Having a couple of different study spots -- your room, a quiet coffee shop, the library -- may help boost your brainpower.

21) Taking Notes

Prepare for exams by way of ‘notes’, which you can recall quickly at the time of taking exam. This will help in two manners. First, when you write, you are in better picture of giving your mind instruction through written letters. Secondly, you can revise from your notes instead of opening the book when exam day is near. Here is my strategy for taking notes:

- Take a paper and turn it in landscape format.
- –Put three columns in landscape form.
- –Once done, take synopsis of a chapter in smaller fonts and the language, which you can easily understand.
- Write bullet points, important concepts and key ideas which you need to remember.
- These notes should be used at the time when paper is on hand and you need to revise whole subject in two to three hours.

22) Figure Out If You Are a Morning, Day or Night Person

This advice will be extremely helpful to you when you are planning the times to take your PMP Exam. For me, I have always been a morning person. Therefore, I would plan to take the test at 8:00am, right after a fresh cup of coffee and ready to attack the exam. Some of my colleagues would take the exam around 5:30pm, right after a long day of work or school classes and would be exhausted by the time they took their exam. However, others wanted to take the exam in the daytime, after they got over their morning hangover, and fit in a few more chapters of material before taking the exam. Whatever time is best for you, that is when you need to schedule your exam. Period.

23) Reward Yourself For The Little Triumphs

Lets face it. The more time you spend studying for the PMP Exam, the less time you have for everything and everyone else in your life. Therefore, squeeze in some time to actually breath and have a little fun. Use this time as a reward for when you complete milestones in your study material or even pass a part of the PMP Exam. If you are planning on knocking out 3 sections of the study material for BEC this week and by Saturday you are finished with the material, take Sunday off. Don't look or even think about your study material and go out and enjoy your day. This will help you stay motivated to take on the next chapter or the next exam. You can even plan bigger rewards for when you pass a section of the exam, like take a short weekend trip to the beach, etc. It's completely up to you but make sure you're not just completely

miserable and look like this when you come out of the whole exam process.

24) Use Memory Aids

It can be quite hard to remember all the things you need to know in an exam, so use memory aids if you need to. No, I don't mean write the answers on your arm! When you had to remember the colors of the spectrum, you were probably taught to use a memory aid such as "Richard of York gave battle in vain" [red orange yellow green blue indigo violet]. You can take this idea a stage further and memorize lists of things you need to remember or even entire plans for essays you might have to write. All you have to do is take the initial letter of each thing you want to remember and make up a sentence that helps you remember the letters. You can then remember in order half a dozen essays simply by memorizing six simple sentences! I memorized dozens of essay plans this way when I was a student. The only thing you have to be careful about is that you do actually...

25) Get a good night sleep

It may not sound like it, but one of the best things you can do to help you remember things is to get a good night sleep – not just the night before the exam, but every night. We're not just saying that because getting the right amount of sleep will help you perform better, retain mental agility and ward off stress and tiredness. We're saying it because it's when you're sleeping that your brain performs the vital task of converting facts from short-term memory into long-term memory. During the course of a good night's sleep, your brain processes the information you've learnt during the day and stores it, meaning that you're far more likely to be able to recall it than if you barely slept. So, get the recommended eight hours' sleep each and every night. Sleep may feel like a luxury you can't afford right now, but believe us, it's one of the most important things you can do for exam success!

26) Fill in the tough spot

It can hurt your head to learn new things. Identify the areas with which you struggle, and try to get your head around them. Two weeks before the exam, I still had some head-pain topics. Things like duration matching, convexity, interest rate swaps, and put-call parity. But, they were on my daily study schedule, and I forced myself to confront them each day. It paid off.

27) Attack your textbook with sticky notes

As you read, summarize (write down the main points in just a few sentences) each section of the chapter on a post-it note. After you have read the entire chapter and summarized each section, go back and review the post-it notes. Reading the post-it notes is an easy and fast way to review information and, since each note is stuck in the section it summarizes, you can easily find the information you need.

28) Create visual flashcards

Flashcards aren't just for primary students. Many college students find them useful as well! Before you take a test, make flashcards that will help you remember important terms, people, places, and dates. Use one 3x5 index for each term. On the front of the card, write down the term or question you need to answer and draw a picture that will help you remember it. This will help ensure that you grasp the study material as you'll find that it's almost impossible to sketch something you don't really understand.

On the back of the card write down the definition of the term or the answer to the question. Review these cards and quiz yourself before your actual test.

In conclusion, I would just say....

“Do Your Best in Whatever You Do and Don't Leave It Incomplete”

Part - II: FOR PMP EXAM

CHAPTER

Blueprint Of The PMP® Examination

Brief History of PMBOK

- Who thought a dinner meeting among 3 people at the Three Trees Restaurant in early 1969 would turn into one of the most prestigiously professional institute of its time.
- James Snyder, Eric Jenett, Gordon Davis, A. E. “Ned” Engman and Susan C. Gallagher are the five founding members of the PMI Organization that was established in the state of Pennsylvania, USA
- First PMP® certificate was awarded to Mr. Eric Jenett in 1984, who was one of the founding member of the PMI Organization

PMBOK Release History

Edition	Year	Number Of Processes
First Edition	1996	37
2000 Edition	2000	39
Third Edition	2004	39
Fourth Edition	2009	42
Fifth Edition	2013	47
Sixth Edition	2017	49

The PMP® Examination

- The 4 hour exam consists of 200 questions and all questions are objective (multiple options, single correct answer)
- Out of 200 questions, 175 are used for scoring the exam and remaining 25 (considered as pre test questions) are to validate future examination questions. One twist here is, all 200 questions are placed randomly so you won't know the scoring and non scoring questions

The questions are distributed in 5 process groups as given below:

Distribution of Questions:

Process Group	%	Approx. Questions
Initiating	13	26
Planning	24	48
Executing	30	60
Monitoring & Controlling	25	50
Closing	8	16
Total	100	200

The Passing Score: The passing score for the PMP examination is determined by sound psychometric analysis. PMI® uses subject matter experts from world wide to help establish a point at which each candidate should pass the examination(s) and the examination point of difficulty.

For the most up-to-date and complete information about the Exam, please visit the PMP® Credential Hand Book in certification section of the PMI's web site: <http://www.pmi.org>

CHAPTER

Preparing For The PMP Exam – 10 Myths

What is a myth?

Merriam-Webster.com defines a myth as “a person or thing having only an imaginary or unverifiable existence”. As you would expect for any exam, there are so many myths about the PMP exam, most of which are false and others half-truths. One thing that you have to know however is that by getting these clear, nothing can stand between you and passing the exam.

Here are some of the 10 most common myths about the PMP Exam.

1) Myth: The exam is totally based on PMBOK Guide

Fact: The exam is all-inclusive, and includes everything within the scope of project management. The PMBOK only provides you with an insight into the topics that will be covered. Do not forget the fact that this is just but a guide; therefore you should be sure to use other relevant texts alongside it like Rita Mulcahy’s “PMP© Exam Prep” or Kim Heldman’s Project Management Professional Study Guide. Apart from that, you will also need your experience in real life to guide you through.

2) Myth: Just experience is enough to pass the exam

Fact: In as much as you might be experienced in the field, the exam requires you to provide answers based on the PMI insight, not your own. Apart from that, experiences might differ from one individual to the other, and as a result it would be best for you to go through the PMBOK guide before you get ready for the exam.

3) Myth: PMP Certification certifies that I know project management

Fact: The PMP certification only proves that you have the qualifications

to carry out particular project management roles, and it does not really mean that you can. This is because different people might not really have the practical skills required of a particular project. Someone said, “PMP credential holders perform a role and the PMP credential helps identify your qualifications to perform that role”

4) Myth: PMP Certifications is good for company not for individuals

Fact: PMP certification is one of the best ways of advancing your career especially if your career concerns project management. Therefore when you go for this exam, you should have it in your mind that you are making yourself a better person, and improving your chances of employment and promotions.

5) Myth: PMP Exam is difficult to pass

Fact: There isn't an exam that is very easy to pass. To succeed in any test, you must be ready to work hard and persevere. There are a number of students who have taken their time and passed the exam in as little time as possible, some even in two months. You must have the desire burning in you to make it. Otherwise you will be filled with negative attitudes. Everything comes in its own time and for this reason you should be ready to work as hard as possible for you to pass. You need to plan it, act it and persevere it till it is achieved. Immediate action; is the key to success. Don't wait for everything to be in place. Start it, things will come in its own place as per its importance and urgency.

6) Myth: Always one right answer to the question in the exam

Fact: In most cases, at least two answers are always right. Therefore the trick is to pick out the most reasonable of them all. For this you should think in terms of eliminating the ones that sound wrong.

7) Myth: Too much time required for the preparation of the exam

Fact: The most important thing that you should learn to do is to think and reason and understand what you are studying. From the concepts to the

management process areas, all these you should be ready to understand to your level best. Do not exhaust yourself reading so many books yet you do not understand a thing from any of them. As a matter of fact, this exam tests your understanding of what you are doing, not how much you can cram.

8) Myth: The score of PMP exam is measured in percentage

Fact: Percentage of score is not available. PMP Exam rates you on various process groups, like "proficient", "moderately proficient", "below proficient" etc. on five process groups. There is no percentage of score involved. Also, you can be at a "below proficient" level in certain process groups, but can still pass the exam.

9) Myth: There is no value now in PMP Certification

Fact: No, it is still an exclusive club. It is one of the best project management courses available with world-class practices and methodologies such as EVM, Monte Carlo, Decision Tree, CPM, Six Sigma, etc. It is also ISO certified. PMBOK continuously improves itself by adopting new practices and methodologies. Also it is one of the toughest exam's to crack.

10) Myth: Only a Registered Education Provider can provide 35 contact hours

Fact: There are a number of places where the program can be offered, including the following:

- Training companies and consultants
- Component organizations of PMI
- Registered Education Providers by PMI
- Continuing education programs in colleges and campuses
- Programs sponsored by companies or even employers
- Distance learning companies

Therefore you do not need to be a R.E.P to offer PMP training. However

for the PMP certification students, this is very important and you should make sure that you check clearly the quality of the faculty and the material that they offer.

There are a number of things that are required of a project manager, including the fact that they never wait for a risk to become a real problem for them to deal with it. Apart from that, you do not have to push problems that you face to the upper management, but you should be ready to deal with them as soon as they happen.

Another thing that will assist you is to think about how proactive you are supposed to be, and consider the very first course of action that someone in your position should come up with.

11) Bonus Myth: 35 Contact Hours are valid for one year only

Fact: That's not the case. 35 contact hours earned from attending project management training are valid for life. In fact, if you have attended Statistic lectures in your college or university, even those hours can also be considered as part of the 35 contact hours, but make sure you don't put all the 35 hours as attended training in Statistics.

How clarifying the myths will help you?

By getting to clarify the myths that surround the PMP exam, it is easy for you to go for the exam with a clear mind. This is very important since it will also keep you focused on what you need to do, and apart from that also make you ready to face whatever questions that will be set in the exam for you to tackle.

CHAPTER

Read This Cheat Sheet By K.A. Just 2 Hours Before The Exam

The purpose of this cheat sheet is to summarize what you studied during your preparation for the PMP exam. These are essential points on each knowledge areas of PMBOK and Agile Section. It is like reading whole PMBOK in 30 minutes. Read this every night before going to bed. This will help you summarize what you studied during the day as well as what you already studied earlier or about to study.

Also, review these important points just two hours before the exam then relax and feel the fun of passing the exam before entering the test center. It will increase your confidence level, speed the flow of blood in your body and help you remember during the test.

So here we go:

BASIC FUNDAMENTALS OF PROJECT MANAGEMENT

- According to the PMBOK, a "project" is a temporary endeavor undertaken to create a unique product or service.
- A portfolio is a collection of projects or programs and other work that are grouped together to facilitate effective management of that work to meet strategic business objectives. The projects or programs in the portfolio may not necessarily be interdependent or directly related.
- Project Portfolio Management is a management process to select the projects that should be invested in. Specifically, it is the selection process based on the need, profitability, and affordability of the proposed projects.
- A project management office (PMO) is an organizational unit to centralize and coordinate the management of projects under its domain. A PMO can also be referred to as a "program management

office," "project office," or "program office." A PMO oversees the management of projects, programs, or a combination of both

- Project management is the application of knowledge, skills, tools, and techniques to project activities to meet the project requirements
- The contract between the organization and the vendor super cedes all other work related documents
- Customers, internal or external, are the most important stakeholders in a project
- Scope verification must take place at the end of each phase
- Money already spent on a project is called sunk cost and should not be taken into consideration when determining if a project should continue. Instead, the cost of the work to complete is one of the elements that should be taken into consideration when considering to kill a project
- Phase end reviews are also called phase exits, milestones, phase gates, stage gates or kill points.
- The project life cycle goes through a series of phases to create the product
- Project managers manage things, but lead people.
- Project
 - Projects don't last forever. They are temporary and unique
 - Projects pass through logical phases to reach their completion
 - Purpose of Project is to attain its objective and then terminate
- Operations
 - Operations, however, do go on and on. They are ongoing and repetitive
 - Operations may be influenced, or even created, by the outcome of a project
 - Objective of an ongoing operation is to sustain business

- Once objectives have been met, new directions are followed to support the organization's plans
- Organization Structure
 - Functional
 - Matrix
 - Weak
 - Balanced
 - Strong
 - Projectized
- The WBS is a decomposition of all the deliverables the project will create

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Integration Management

- Project charter formally authorizes the project and allows the PM to apply organizational resources to project activities.
- Charter contains requirements, business needs, justification, assumptions and constraints and summary budget and schedule.
- Sponsor input is critical to charter
- Early identification of stakeholders is critical to successful project management
- Enterprise Environmental Factors can be internal or external, and include things like organizational culture, government regulations, stakeholder risk tolerance, PMIS and commercial databases.
- Organizational Process Assets include the organizations processes and procedures for conducting work and the corporate knowledge base for storing and retrieving information, as well as historical information about past work.
- **Project Selection:** Mathematical methods (linear programming) vs. Comparative methods (peer review, cost-benefit analysis).

- **Project Management Methodology:** Methodology contains guiding processes for those who are doing project management. There are several project management methodologies; some of them are Agile, Traditional, Waterfall, Adaptive, Critical Path, PERT, Rational Unified Process, Critical Chain, Extreme, Scrum, Six Sigma and more.
- **Project Management Information System:** Software that helps you manage project. This includes the configuration management system and the change control system.
- **Management Plans:** Management Plans specify how you will define, plan, manage and control each knowledge area. These all become part of the Project Management Plan.
- **Project Management Plan:** Remember this is not just a bar chart! It's all the subsidiary management plans plus baselines for cost, scope, quality and schedule (and possible resources). The project will be measured against these baselines.
- **Corrective Action:** A change to bring the project performance back in line with the plan. Recommended Corrective Actions are generally outputs of the Monitoring and Controlling Process Group Processes. Recommended Corrective Actions must be approved and implemented.
- **Preventative Action:** Preventative actions are done in anticipation of problems that could cause project performance to deviate from the baseline. If these problems actually occurred, they would need Corrective Actions, but we're trying to head off this situation.
- **Defect Repair:** This is rework required when an output of the project does not meet specifications.
- **Perform Integrated Change Control:** All changes, no matter how small, must go through integrated change control for approval. The project manager's job when changes are suggested are to:
 - Evaluate change impact
 - Create options for minimizing change impact

- Get approval from Change Control Board
- Get approval from customer (where required)
- **Close Project** must always be done, even for cancelled or failed projects. It involves developing and executing the administrative closure procedure, and developing the contract closure procedure. Contract Closure process was eliminated in PMBOK 6th edition and is now part of Close Project process.

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Scope Management

- **Collect Requirements:** Describe how to define, verify and control scope and how to create WBS.
- **Define Scope:** Create scope statement; this will guide future decisions. Describes deliverables and work required to create them.
- **Create WBS:** Deliverable oriented hierarchy that breaks down the work to be done.
- **Validate Scope:** Validating and approving project deliverables against the baseline and gaining acceptance from the customer.
- **Control Scope:** Controlling changes related to scope. Approved scope must be exactly what is implemented, no more, no less.
- **Product scope** is requirements that relate to the production of a product; project scope is the work required to complete the project.
- **Scope baseline:** Project scope statement, WBS, WBS Dictionary.
- **WBS is** broken down from the top. The lowest level in the WBS is a work package, but even this is broken down further into schedule activities during activity definition. Work packages are charged to control accounts for cost management. The word task is not used in the PMI vocabulary; think "work package" and "schedule activity" instead.
- The WBS is just numbers and titles; the WBS dictionary provides the textual explanations required (statement of work, defined

deliverables, responsible individuals, milestones, etc.)

- WBS is the most important element in project management planning. It should exist for every project.
- WBS identifies all work to be performed; if it's not in the WBS, it shouldn't be in the project. Beware of scope creep and gold plating!
- WBS is a tool to assist the project manager in decomposition.
- WBS does not show dependencies the way a network diagram does

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Schedule Management

- **Define Activities:** Breaking down the work packages in the WBS to activities that can be completed in two weeks or less.
- **Sequence Activities:** Creating a network diagram from activities, showing the dependencies. When durations are added (next step), the network diagram also shows the critical path.
- **Estimate Activity Durations:** Determine how long each activity will take.
- **Develop Schedule:** Analyzing activity sequences, durations and resource requirements to create the project schedule.
- **Control Schedule:** Managing changes to the schedule. Remember all changes must go through Integrated Change Control.
- **Precedence Diagramming Method (PDM) or Activity on Node (AON)** style network diagrams have nodes representing activities and arrows representing dependencies. Four dependencies can be shown: finish to start, start-to-start, finish-to-finish and start to finish.
- **Arrow Diagramming Method (ADM) or Activity on Arrow (AOA)** style network diagrams have arrows representing activities and nodes representing dependencies. This type of diagram can only show finish to start relationships.
- **Types of Dependencies:** Hard logic - mandatory dependency, or soft logic - discretionary dependency, external dependency.
- **Leads and Lags:** A lag is a delay in starting a successor. A lead is

when the successor can be started before the current task is complete.

- **Estimating methods:** One time estimate, analogous estimate, parametric estimate, heuristics, and three-point estimate.
- **Reserve analysis** should be done for estimates (time and cost). Contingency reserve covers known unknowns; Management Reserve covers unknown unknowns.
- **PERT - Formulas are:**
 - Activity Length $= (P+4M+O) / 6$
 - Activity Std. Dev $= (P-O) / 6$
 - Activity Variance $= ((P-O) / 6)^2$
- Where P is the pessimistic estimate, O is the optimistic estimate and M is the most likely estimate. Remember that you cannot simply add standard deviations; you must calculate variances (the standard deviation squared), sum them and then take the square root.
- Critical path - Determine the longest duration path through a network; this will be the shortest time in which the project can be completed.
- Activity duration is EF - ES or LF - LS
- Activity float is LS - ES or LF - EF
- **Total Float:** amount of time an activity can be delayed without delaying the project.
- **Free Float:** amount of time an activity can be delayed without delaying its successor.
- **Project Float:** amount of time the project can be delayed without delaying the date requested by the customer or senior management.
- Activities with zero floats are on the critical path.
- CPM is deterministic, using specific durations; PERT is probabilistic, using statistical estimates of durations.
- PERT uses weighted averages; CPM just sums up activity durations.

- Schedule compression techniques include crashing (adding resources) and fast tracking (performing activities in parallel that would normally be done sequentially).
- What-if - Monte Carlo analysis performed by computer allows us to evaluate the likelihood of various outcomes.
- **Resource Leveling:** Allowing schedule and cost slip in order to deal with limited resources.
- **Critical Chain:** Adding duration buffers to various milestones to increase the probability of success.
- **Chart types**
 1. Milestone Charts - good for reporting to management, customer. Shows only major events.
 2. Bar Charts (or Gantt Charts) - Shows durations (but not dependencies). Good for progress reporting and discussions with the team.
 3. PERT charts - similar to AON, but generally done at a higher level. (Remember AON is done at the activity level, which is below the work package level.) Shows dependencies, unlike Gantt.
- Remember that a bar chart is not a WBS or a project management plan.
- Progress Reporting: How team members report percent complete.
- 50/50, 0/100, 0-50-100 are common ways.

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Cost Management

- Cost variances can be caused by many factors. Triple constraint provides a basis for cost management tradeoffs.
- Cost management plan: states how costs will be controlled, estimating units of measure, estimating precision, permissible variance thresholds, earned value rules and reporting formats.
- Learning curve theory: costs decline by a fixed percentage every

time unit production doubles.

- Sum of year's digits depreciation: sum the total number of years of an asset's life (10 years: $1+2+3...+10=55$). Then take the highest year's number and divide by the total - so in year 1, the depreciation would be $10/55$, in year 2 it would be $9/55$, etc.
- Double declining depreciation: Depreciate a fixed rate over the life of the asset, but only depreciate the depreciated value. If the rate is 50%, year 1 depreciate 50% of the cost, in year 2, depreciate 50% of 50% of the cost, and so forth down to 0.
- Overhead rate = $(\text{charge rate per hour} - \text{pay rate per hour}) / \text{pay rate per hour}$.
- Cost baseline is a time-phased budget that is used to control cost performance. S-curve shaped.
- **Cost account codes:** one level above the WBS work packages. Work package costs are rolled up to this level and compared with budget.
- **Estimating methods:** Rough order of magnitude, definitive (bottom up), parametric, analogous. As estimate accuracy increases, so does the cost of estimate preparation.
- ROM estimates are between -50% to +100% of actual, later estimates are between -10% and +15%. These are PMBOK definitions; other authorities use the following definitions: order of magnitude (-25% to +75%), preliminary estimate (-15% to +50%), budget estimate (-10% to +25%) and definitive estimate (-5% to +10%).
- Rolling wave planning can be used to estimate risky projects. Re-estimate as you move forward.
- **Life Cycle Costing:** consider the full product life, not just project life, when doing costing.
- **Cost aggregation:** roll up activity costs to work package, work package costs to control account, control account costs to project. Project plus contingency reserve = cost baseline, cost baseline plus

management reserve = cost budget.

- Contingency reserve is included in cost baseline; management reserve is not.
- Budget must be checked against cash flow. This is also called funding limit reconciliation
- **Progress formulas:**
 - o $CV = EV - AC$
 - o $SV = EV - PV$
- **Efficiency indicators:**
 - o $CPI = EV/AC$
 - o $SPI = EV/PV$
- **Forecasting formulas**
 - o $EAC = BAC/CPI$ (typical or no variances)
 - o $EAC = AC + ETC$ (if ETC had to be re-estimated)
 - o $ETC = BAC - EV$ (current variances are not typical)
 - o $ETC = (BAC - EV) / CPI$ (current variances are typical)
- **Older acronyms:** BCWS (PV), BCWP (EV), ACWP (AC).
- **Value analysis:** Decreasing project cost while maintaining scope and performance.
- Earned value measurement can give you a true picture of project status.
- Reporting earned value percent complete: 50/50 method (report half when started, the rest when done), 0/50/100 method, 0/100 method, by milestones. Other methods are cost formula, equivalent units, level of effort.
- **Present value:** $PV = FV / (1 + r)^n$, where r is the interest rate and n is the number of time periods. Don't worry about the formula, just remember that the present value of money is greater than the future

value of money, and this formula describes how much greater (the variables being the interest rate and the time involved).

- **Payback period:** The time it takes to recover the initial investment, computed by summing the investment's cash inflows. This is considered a very rough tool because it does not take into account the time value of money. Remember that a shorter payback period is preferred to a longer one.
- **Net Present Value:** The sum of all the present values for the required time periods.
- **NPV equation:** Just remember that a higher net present value is better than a lower one. NPV is a much more precise capital budgeting method than payback period.
- **Internal rate of return:** The interest rate at which the present value of the cash flows equals the initial investment. Just remember that a higher IRR is better than a lower one. IRR is a more precise (and more conservative) capital budgeting method than NPV.
- The four methods just discussed for capital budgeting (present value, payback period, NPV, IRR) are all used to in the project selection process. Risk is also a factor – near term cash flows are considered less risky than cash flows far in the future.

Formulas You Must Know

Acronym's used in Formulas:

AC	Actual Cost of the Work Performed
BAC	Budget at Completion (Project budget)
CV	Cost Variance
CPI	Cost Performance Index
EAC	Estimate at Completion
ETC	Estimate to Complete
EV	Earned Value (Budgeted Cost of the Work Performed)

PV Planned Value (Budgeted Cost of the Work Scheduled)

SV Schedule Variance

SPI Schedule Performance Index

VAC Variance at Completion

Cost and Schedule Formulas

$$CV = EV - AC$$

$$SV = EV - PV$$

$$CPI = EV / AC$$

$$SPI = EV / PV$$

CV and SV are also known as progress formulas. CPI and SPI are also known as efficiency indicators.

CV (cost variance) measures money. SV (schedule variance) measures time. To get from CV to CPI or SV to SPI, just change the minus sign to a division sign. CPI and SVI are efficiency indicators.

With CV and SV, positive values are good (under budget, ahead of schedule). Similarly, with CPI and SPI, values greater than 1 are good.

Remember that in the cost and schedule formulas, EV is always the first value.

Forecasting Formulas

$$\text{(Typical or no variances) EAC} = BAC / CPI$$

$$\text{(atypical variances) EAC} = AC + (BAC - EV)$$

$$\text{(typical variances) EAC} = AC + (BAC - EV) / CPI$$

$$\text{(atypical variances) ETC} = BAC - EV$$

$$\text{(typical variances) ETC} = (BAC - EV) / CPI$$

Note that the second formulation for EAC could be restated as

$$EAC = AC + ETC$$

ETC (estimate to complete) measures work that is still outstanding.

EAC (estimate at completion) measures total work when the project is complete.

Both are calculated differently depending on whether the variances so far are typical or atypical.

- **PERT Formulas for Activity Duration Estimating**

$$\text{Activity Length} = (P + 4M + O) / 6$$

$$\text{Activity Std. Dev} = (P - O) / 6$$

$$\text{Activity Variance} = ((P - O) / 6)^2$$

Where P is the pessimistic estimate, O is the optimistic estimate and M is the most likely estimate.

The Activity Length formula is also known as the "three point estimate."

Remember that you cannot simply add standard deviations; you must calculate variances (the standard deviation squared), sum them and then take the square root.

Critical Path Formulas for Activity Duration Estimating

$$\text{Activity Duration} = EF - ES \text{ or } LF - LS$$

$$\text{Activity Float} = LS - ES \text{ or } LF - EF$$

Remember CPM is deterministic, using specific durations; PERT is probabilistic, using statistical estimates of durations.

Quality Formulas (Normal Distribution)

$$1 \text{ sigma} = 68.26\%$$

$$2 \text{ sigma} = 95.46\%$$

$$3 \text{ sigma} = 99.73\%$$

$$6 \text{ sigma} = 99.99985\%$$

Financial Formulas

These formulas are used in budgeting and project selection.

Payback period: number of years until the sum of future cash flows equals the initial investment.

PV equation

NPV equation

IRR equation

Examples of using the financial formulas

- Payback Period: Obviously this is an extremely rough calculation, which does not take into account the time value of money. If the initial investment is \$10,000, and the cash flows are:

Year	Amount (FV)
1	\$2000
2	\$2000
3	\$2000
4	\$2000
5	\$2000
6	\$2000
7	\$2000
8	\$2000

then the payback period is 5 years.

- **PV:** The present value is the discounted value of a future cash flow. A "discount" is required because the present value of money is

greater than the future value of money.

It is expressed: $PV = FV / (1 + r)^n$, where r is the interest rate (or cost of capital) and n is the years.

What is the present value of an investment that pays \$10,000 five years from now with an interest rate of 10%?

$$\$10,000 / (1 + .1)^5 = \$6209$$

- **NPV:** The net present value is the sum of all future discounted cash flows. Using the calculations from the payback period example, and assuming a 10% cost of capital

Year	Amount (FV)	PV
1	\$2000	\$1818
2	\$2000	\$1653
3	\$2000	\$1503
4	\$2000	\$1366
5	\$2000	\$1242
6	\$2000	\$1129
7	\$2000	\$1026
8	\$2000	\$933

so the present value of the next 8 years of cash flows is \$10,670.

- Also remember NPV is *net*, so if there is an initial investment, it must be subtracted. In other words, if this investment cost \$10,000, the NPV would be \$670, not \$10,670.
- **IRR:** the Internal Rate of Return is the discount rate when the present value of cash flows is the same as the initial investment.

Higher IRRs are preferred to lower ones. IRR is determined by trial and error, computing NPV with various interest rates.

Other Formulas

$$EV = (\% \text{ complete}) * BAC$$

$$VAC = BAC - EAC$$

$$\text{Communication Channels} = (N*(N-1))/2 \quad [\text{where } N \text{ is no. of parties}]$$

$$\text{Overhead rate} = \frac{(\text{charge rate per hour} - \text{pay rate per hour})}{\text{Pay rate per hour}}$$

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Quality Management

- Quality is the degree to which a project meets its requirements.
- Quality should be planned in, not inspected in.
- **Quality Planning:** Determining a plan for quality. Identifying applicable standards, specifying how quality will be measured, creating quality management plan.
- **Quality Assurance:** Determining if the project is following organizational and project policies and procedures. Performing continuous improvement, quality audits, recommended changes and corrective actions.
- **Quality Control:** Measuring specific project results against standards. Testing, repairing defects, validating deliverables.
- Quality is not grade; grade is assigned to products with the same functional use but different technical characteristics.
- **Costs of conformance to quality:** training, studies, surveys, etc. Costs of non-conformance: rework, scrap, warranty costs, etc.
- **Sigma:** Another name for standard deviation; indicates how much of the curve is within control limits. 1 sigma = 68.26%, 2 sigma = 95.46%, 3 sigma = 99.73%, 6 sigma = 99.99985%.
- **Quality Baseline:** records quality objectives; basis for reporting quality performance as part of the performance measurement

baseline

- **Tolerance:** result is acceptable if it falls within tolerance. Control limits: process is in control if results fall within control limits. Specification limits: customer's expectation of quality. Specification limits must be outside control limits or the performing organization will have trouble meeting the contract terms.
- **Cost of Quality:** The expense associated with the quality processes. Also called "cost of acceptance."
- **Variable inspection:** an actual measurement of a part. Attribute inspection: a yes or no determination of whether a part is good or bad.
- **Kaizen:** continuous improvement - small improvements in products or processes. The cumulative effect of these small changes over time can be quite large.
- **First Time Yield:** Is the probability that 1 unit can pass through the process without defects (the product of all probabilities).
- **Rolled Through Yield:** Is the ratio of good outputs to good inputs. For a multiphase process, it is the product of all these ratios.
- **Quality Control Tools:** Seven basic tools of Quality:
 1. Cause and effect diagram (fishbone, Ishikawa) - creative way to look at possible problem causes.
 2. Control charts - shows how a process behaves over time; plots results against control limits (usually ± 3 sigma). Data within limits indicate the process is in control, but watch for rule of 7: 7 consecutive results on one side of the mean could indicate a problem. $\bar{X}$ is the average of a series of measurements; R is the difference between the highest and lowest values for a period, $\bar{R}$ is the average of all the R -values.
 3. Flowcharting - graphical representation of a process.
 4. Histogram - bar chart showing distribution of variables. Each column is an attribute of a problem; height of the column shows its frequency.

5. Pareto chart: type of histogram ordered by frequency of occurrence. Problems are on the X-axis and frequency is on the Y-axis. Summarizes 80/20 analyses.
6. Run Chart: Shows history and patterns of variation; used for trend analysis and predicting future outcomes based on historical results. Similar to a control chart but without the upper and lower limits.
7. Scatter Diagram: Tracks two variables to see if they are related. If the points form a diagonal line, they are related.

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Resource Management

- **Estimate Activity Resources:** After sequencing, resource needs must be determined. Resources may be people, equipment or materials.
- **Human Resource Planning:** Consider enterprise environmental factors, organizational process assets, project organizational charts & position descriptions, staffing management plan, resource histograms, and recognition and reward system.
- **Project organizational charts & position descriptions:** responsibility assignment matrix, organizational breakdown structure, resource breakdown structure, and position description.
- **Acquire Resources:** Acquiring Resources is the process of securing team members, equipment, materials or other resources required to deliver the project.
- **Develop Team:** training, team building, ground rules, collocation, giving out recognition and rewards.
- **Manage Team:** manage and measure performance.
- **Control Resources:** is the process of ensuring that the resources assigned and allocated to the project are available as planned and on right time and place
- An output of Develop Team process is the team performance assessment and same becomes input to Manage Team process.

- **Powers of the Project Manager:** Some of them are reward, penalty (coercive), expert, formal (legitimate) and referent
- **Leadership:** Consensus decision-making is not always best; in the early stages, the project manager has the most knowledge about the project and is best positioned to make decisions.
- Conflict is unavoidable because of limited resources. The top causes of conflict are not personality, but rather schedules, project priorities, resources and technical opinions.
- **Conflict resolution techniques:** confronting (problem-solving), compromising, withdrawing, smoothing, forcing.
- **Motivational theories:**
 - McGregor's theory of X and Y: theory X says people seek to avoid work; theory Y says they want to achieve.
 - Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs: Self-actualization, esteem, social, safety and physiological.
 - Herzberg's theory of Hygiene factors: poor factors destroy motivation, but improving good ones doesn't help; motivating agents are growth and recognition

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Communication Management

- **Methods:** formal written, formal verbal, informal written, informal verbal
- 90% of a project manager's time is spent in communication.
- Formula for Number of Communication Channels: $N*(N-1)/2$
- **Plan Communications Management:** what, why, whom, how, when.
- Information distribution: this is the implementation of the communications management plan.
- Creating lessons learned is part of communication. Capture what was done right, wrong, and what would be done differently if it were done again. Lessons learned documents become part of the

organizational process assets.

- **Performance Reporting:** Updating stakeholders with various types of performance data (status, earned value, variance, trends, progress, etc.)
- Performance is always reported against the baseline established in the project management plan.
- **Manage Stakeholders:** Make stakeholders feel their needs and concerns are being considered, even if not agreed to.
- **Things that impede communication:** noise, distance, language, culture, etc.
- Approved change requests is output of Perform Integrated Change Control process and of Manage Stakeholders Engagement process

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Risk Management

- The purpose of risk management is to increase the probability and impact of positive risks (opportunities), while decreasing the probability and impact of negative risks (threats).
- Risk can be seen as a function of likelihood and impact, or a function of hazard and safeguard. You must also consider the timing of the risk event, and the frequency.
- **Risk Tolerance:** stakeholders may be risk averse, risk neutral, or risk seeking.
- Risk Management starts with Plan Risk Management and the creation of the Risk Management Plan. This plan identifies the risk management methodology, roles and responsibilities, reporting format, and definitions of probability and impact.
- **Techniques for Risk Identification:** nominal group technique, Delphi technique, brainstorming, and root cause analysis.
- Qualitative risk analysis focuses on probability time impact. This leads to risk prioritization.
- Quantitative risk analysis uses mathematical models to further refine risk prioritization.

- Risk Response planning for threats:
 - Avoid
 - Transfer (Deflect, Allocate)
 - Mitigate
 - Accept (passively or actively)
- Risk Response planning for opportunities:
 - Exploit
 - Enhance
 - Share
 - Accept (passively or actively)
- **Risk categories:** external - unpredictable, external - predictable, internal nontechnical, internal - technical, legal.
- Another broad categorization: insurable risk and business risk
- Risk identification (or risk assessment) begins as early as the charter but is not complete until the end of planning. Even then we must continually monitor for new risks as things change, so risk identification will be done in the monitoring and controlling process group.
- Risk Register is the chief output of Identify Risk process. After Risk Identification, it would contain a list of risks, potential responses, root causes and categories.
- Risk Register is also updated and refined by other risk processes.
- After Qualitative Analysis, the risks have priorities, and probability and impact ratings.
- After Quantitative Analysis, risks have contingency time and cost reserves.
- After Risk Response Planning, risks have specific named owners. Contingency and fallback plans are also created at this point.

- Perform Qualitative Analysis is a subjective analysis of project risks:
 - Probability and impact ratings
 - Assessment of the quality and reliability of risk data
 - Updating the risk categories - if you slice and dice the risks differently, do you get different answers?
 - Risk urgency evaluation.
 - Overall project risk ranking.
- Perform Quantitative Analysis is a numerical analysis of project risks:
 - Quantifies probability and impact ratings.
 - Quantifies cost and schedule reserves.
 - Techniques include expert judgment, data gathering, interpersonal and team skills, representations of uncertainty and data analysis.
- Implement Risk Responses is the process of implementing agree-upon risk response plans
- Eliminating risks
- Decreasing probability/impact of risk
- Make a contingency plan if the risk occurs
- Make a fallback plan if the contingency plan fails
- Risk triggers indicate that a risk is about to occur or has occurred. These can also be tracked in the Risk Register.
- Expected monetary value and decision tree scenarios are important - you should know how to solve them.

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Procurement Management

- All requirements must be stated in the contract. Contracts are formal documents that are legally binding.

- If it's in the contract, it must be done. If it's not in the contract, it can only be done if both parties sign a change order.
- Most organizations have contract managers who are primarily responsible for contracts. They may also be called procurement officers or contract officers.
- Project managers must help contract managers by ensuring that the contract contains all product requirements and all project management requirements (status reports, meeting attendance, etc.).
- In some companies, contract management staffs are centralized; in others, they are distributed. The advantages and disadvantages of these approaches are analogous to Functional vs. Projectized organizations.
- Inputs to procurement management include enterprise environmental factors, organizational process assets, baselines for project scope, schedule and cost, and risk register.
- **Make or buy analysis:** buying may reduce triple constraint risk, but consider whole costs of buying, including costs of managing procurement. Building may be appropriate if you have extra capacity or want to maintain control.
- A "buy or lease" problem is similar to a "make or buy" problem - consider all costs and see where it becomes more expensive to lease.
- **Contract types:** Fixed price, time and materials, cost reimbursable.
- **Fixed price:** the cost of the contract is set when the contract is signed; the risk of higher costs is borne by the seller. A purchase order is an example of a fixed price contract. Sometimes fixed price contracts include incentive fees for early completion or price adjustments over time.
- **Time and materials:** Have elements of fixed price (fixed hourly rate) and cost reimbursable (total costs are unknown).
- **Cost reimbursable:** seller's costs are reimbursed plus an additional amount, usually a percentage of cost. Research projects where there are many unknowns are well suited to cost reimbursable contracts.

- Other examples of cost reimbursable contracts:
 - Cost plus fixed fee (fee fixed so seller not rewarded for cost overrun; fee only changes with approved change order)
 - Cost plus percentage of costs/cost plus fee - buyer pays all costs plus a percentage of costs or a fee
 - Cost plus incentive fee (bonus for beating performance objectives)
 - Cost plus award fee (bonus determined in advance and disbursed over time)
- Contract type selection determines how the risk will be distributed between the buyer and the seller. Fixed price is most risky to the seller; cost reimbursable is most risky to the buyer.
- Contract Statement of Work is critical. Having a complete statement of work prevents problems down the road.
- Contract SOW goes with contract type; SOW for FP will be very complete and focus on design of solution; SOW for CR will leave room for interpretation and will focus on the functional and performance attributes of the desired product - the design will be left up to the seller.
- Procurement Management Plan describes how procurement will be planned, managed and executed.
- Plan Contracting: Creating procurement documents (RFP, RFQ, IFB, etc.)
- Procurement documents and contract types (generally) go together: RFPs are well suited for CR contracts; RFQs are well suited for FP contracts.
- IFBs are generally used in government contracts.
- **Request Seller Responses:** Get the procurement documents to the sellers, let them respond. Note that sometimes the sellers are pre-qualified in this process.
- **Select Sellers:** try to make evaluation criteria measurable to

minimize halo effect, personal bias, etc.

- Contract SOW is the main part of the contract, but not the only part. All important terms and conditions must be specified in the contract.
- Legal contract = offer, acceptance, consideration, legal capacity, legal purpose.
- **Contract Management Plan:** specific to one contract, talks about contract administration, contains a list of major to-do items. This is an output of Select Sellers for significant purchases or acquisitions.
- **Contract Administration:** Making sure both parties adhere to the contract. Extra work is required in T & M and CR contracts to be sure invoices are reasonable.
- The number of people who may speak to the seller may be limited. The number of people who can change the contract is almost certainly limited to the contract administrator; the project manager probably doesn't have the authority.
- **Contract Change Control System** is the process for modifying the contract. If there are too many changes, it may be wise to cancel the original contract and make a new one (both parties must agree).
- **Claims:** a claim in a seller's change request - the seller says the buyer did something that was harmful and requesting compensation.
- Records management is important in contract administration - correspondence and logs must be kept in a way that makes them accessible if they are need in the future.
- **Contract Closure:** may be when the contract ends or it may be when the contract is terminated prior to the completion of work.
- Contract closure is considered as part of the Project Integration Management Knowledge Area in PMBOK 6th edition instead of Project Procurement Management Knowledge Area

KNOWLEDGE AREA – Project Stakeholder Management

- Who are they, what are they, and why you should care?
- A stakeholder is someone who is or can be affected by your

business. It can be a person, a group or another organization and they can either affect you positively or negatively.

- Some of the examples are clients, employees, shareholders, contractors, suppliers, unions, media, etc. Think about whom you deal every day, they all are your stakeholders.
- Prioritize your stakeholders by analyzing their influence and interests

- **Project Managers role:**

- Identify stakeholders and also distinguish those who:
 - Has ability to impact your project
 - Has ability to remove the impediments
 - Can enhance your project
 - Can slow down your project
 - Can lead the opinions and
 - Can facilitate the change.
- Develop relationships and trust among stakeholders and individuals
- Manage relationships among your stakeholders
- Benefit from powerful stakeholders

- **Challenges with Stakeholders:**

- Unidentified stakeholders – those who were not identified early in the project
- Unreasonable stakeholders – those who do not embrace the feature as required
- Unclear stakeholders – those who do not clearly articulate – those who are not open and honest about their interests and expectations

AGILE IN A NUTSHELL

- It is a known fact that fewer than a third of all traditional projects are successfully completed on time and on budget
- Traditional Project Management, also called Waterfall Project Management Methodology, assumes that once documented, the requirements will not change - at least not without potential project delays or budget overruns.
- Currently, according to Price Waterhouse Coopers (PwC), Agile projects are more 28% successful than traditional projects.
- Agile is actually a mindset defined by values, guided by principles and manifested through many different practices. Agile practitioners select practices based on their need. There are 4 values, 12 principles and several practices.
- Agile is a software development philosophy that emphasizes on (4 values):
 - Individuals and Interactions over processes and tools
 - Working Software over Comprehensive documentation
 - Customer collaboration over contract negotiation
 - Responding to change over following a plan
- Below are the 12 Guided Principles Practice Guide for 12 guided principles:
 1. Customer satisfaction through continuous delivery
 2. Accept changing requirements
 3. Release Frequently
 4. Collaboration between business people and developers
 5. Motivate and Support Individuals throughout the project
 6. Making face-to-face conversation a norm
 7. Progress is continuously measured
 8. Sponsors, developers and users should be able to maintain a sustainable pace for unlimited
 9. Technical Excellence and good design enhances agility
 10. Keeping things as simple as possible is a great ethic to streamline your process
 11. Build a best team so they are independent and quick in their decision and so are in quick to adopt
 12. Stop, reflect and tweak the way you do things throughout the course of the project
- This philosophy has its own subset of project management methodologies and some the famous methodologies in use are Adaptive Software Development (ASD), Crystal Dynamic Systems Development Method (DSDM) Extreme Programming (XP), Feature Driven Development (FDD), Kanban, Lean, Scrum and more.
- Although Agile is mostly used in software development projects, still around quarter of the manufacturing organizations rely solely on Agile
- PMI considers Agile as ever increasing Project Management Technique.
- The Agile concept is incorporated in all 10 knowledge areas. Each knowledge area contains a section entitled Approaches for Agile,

Iterative and Adaptive Environments, describing how these practices integrate in project settings.

- Agile methodologies such as eXtreme Programming (XP), SCRUM and Feature-Driven Development (FDD) strive to reduce the cost of change throughout the software development process. For example, uses rapid iterative planning and development cycles in order to force trade-offs and deliver the highest value features as early as possible. In addition, the constant, systemic testing that is part of XP ensures high quality via early defect detection and resolution
- Agile is basically to measure and consider the unknown before it is too late
- Agile Practice Guide, which was published by PMI along with the PMBOK Sixth Edition, consists off:
 - Introduction to Agile and why it is more adaptive than Traditional Project Management
 - The Agile Manifesto mindset, values, and principles
 - Definable and high-uncertainty work
 - The correlation between Lean, the Kanban Method and Agile approaches
 - Characteristics of project life cycles and selections
 - Suitability filters
 - Tailoring guidelines
 - Common combinations of approaches
 - Implementing Agile: Creating and Delivering in an Agile Environment
 - Organizational Considerations for Project Agility
 - And A Call to Action
- Top seven benefits of Agile are:
 - Release to market in the quickest time possible
 - Minimize risk of failing to release on budget
 - Stable platform through automated testing
 - Rapid, iterative releases to improve the product
 - Ability to change requirements based on user feedback
 - Highly transparent process
 - One high motivated team is formed from agency and client

VERY IMPORTANT POINTS TO REMEMBER ABOUT PROFESSIONAL RESPONSIBILITY

- This process group is merged with other 5 process groups for the exam questions. Questions won't be asked as separate process group.
- Conduct yourself professionally in your work with clients. This includes the following:
 - Doing the “right” thing
 - Being respectful and cooperative and treating everyone fairly
 - Following the correct procedures
 - Being assertive and taking responsibility of any issue or problem
 - Being cognizant and avoiding any conflict-of interest issues
- Ways to increase the professionalism of project management include the following:
 - Maintaining high standards of personal integrity
 - Continually striving to improve and become more knowledgeable
 - Continually looking for ways to improve the project management practice and the project management knowledge base.

~~~

Read this every night during the preparation of the PMP Exam and lastly 2 hours before the exam.

Remember this and you won't regret you bought this guide.

~~~

CHAPTER

Must Bring Items To The Exam Center

The following items should be considered essential for anyone taking the PMP Exam. Make a list and check it twice because if you forget one of these things, you'll be in serious trouble.

- Take Photo ID
- 2 – Water Bottles
- 2 – Energy Drinks or Sodas (test taking is boring)
- 3 – Snacks
- 1 – Ruler
- 3 – Blank Pages
- 3 – Pencils
- 1 – Eraser
- 1 – Calculator
- 1 – Watch (don't rely on there being a clock in the test center, there likely won't be)
- 2 – Sets of Ear Plugs (it can be loud, this'll keep you from being distracted)
- 1 – Warm Jacket/Sweater

Call the test center weeks ahead and find out what you should carry and can bring to the exam and what you cannot. Ask them what can they provide. Add or remove those items to the above list.

CHAPTER

Want To Fail? Do These 10 Little Things

People fail this exam each and every day, and you should not be surprised if you are among them. Due to lack of proper preparation, you might not pass. However, there are a number of things that you should be ready to do so that you can pass the exam. These are underlined herein

Apart from just studying and getting ready for your exam, you should be keen on the things that can make you fail the exam, and learn how to deal with them, and most importantly, how to make sure that they do not hinder your progress. So below are the 10 most critical little things I bet if you do or think, will not stop you from failing the exam. So avoid those things in any circumstances:

1) It is very easy to pass the exam

Always make sure that you are well prepared for the exam before you go in. The reason for this is that it is not really one of the easiest to pass. This therefore means that if you do not prepare adequately, you are bound to fail. Most importantly, take your test seriously.

2) PMI® processes are never used in my company

The use of the PMBOK® and the PMI® processes in your organization is an advantage for you since you will already have some knowledge of what is required in the PMP exam, at least 20-30%. However, this does not mean that in the event that your organization does not use these processes you will be off track. All you have to do is to stay focused and everything will work out just fine. Therefore you have to be ready to spend as much time and effort as required to understand and become an expert in the PMI® processes and the PMBOK® guide.

3) I am intelligent, I will excel with little preparation

In as much as the exam has multiple answers, this does not mean that you

will easily pick out the right one. As a matter of fact, you have to understand that in most cases there is always at least two answers that all sound right. Therefore the easiest way around this is to take time and prepare adequately for the exam, if you really need to pass it on the first attempt. Unless you have taken time to really study and understand what is required of you, do not think that you will walk into the exam and easily pick out the correct answers.

4) I know the answer at first read

Passing a multiple choice questioned exam is one of the easiest things to do, especially since you have all the answers given to you, and all you need to do is to pick the right one. However, this does not mean that it is indeed as easy as it sounds. What you should really do is to read a question at least three times and comprehend it first before you can think of providing an answer that is required. Never make assumptions or speed through the test; that is the perfect recipe for failure.

The reason for this is that there are some very long questions, and when you rush through them you are highly likely to lose track and give the wrong answer. In such a case you should first read the question then go over the scenario looking through the important aspects. As a matter of fact, you should try and test this first before you attempt an exam.

5) Test center will be calm and comfortable

One thing that you should be aware of is that the testing environment might be a little different than you are used to. There are video cameras all over the place, and it is a room with at least 15-20 persons. Therefore you should get this in your mind before you set out to do the test so that you do not get shocked and nervous.

6) Not enough practice is required

As you go for this exam, you should be well prepared and ready to give it your all. What this means therefore is that you must have conducted a lot of exercises prior to the exam, and as you go in you have to be very confident that you are ready for the exam. However, do not be over confident, this

could ruin you.

One other thing about this and many exams is that the setting will not be according to the flow in the books you have read. This means that the topics will drastically change, and the questions also from definition type questions to application type questions. Do not expect straightforward questions, but be ready to throw in PMI® and PMBOK® processes at any time.

7) What the hell is a study plan, I can finish in 3 nights

As you prepare for the exam, you should have a comprehensive study plan that includes PMP type test questions to get you through. You have to remember that as you study, these tests are very important to you because they will determine whether you are in the right frame of mind to tackle the exam or not.

As you study, aim to make the 85% mark or higher on your practice tests. Though the real exam requires you to get 61% to pass, the conditions in the exam are very different from the ones in your study environment. For this reason therefore you should know that if you are not hitting anything within the 85% and above range, you might not really be prepared for this exam

To have a chance of passing the exam, you should be well versed with the five process groups and all the knowledge areas

8) Study materials are freely available on the internet

Studying the wrong material is a very common thing with a lot of students. From the Internet to a number of texts in the bookstores, all of these purport to assist you in passing your exam. There is some practice questions that according to the current PMBPOK® scheme is outdated. As a matter of fact, some of the advice that these study guides offer you are not even relevant and could only serve to derail you.

To be on the safe side, work with the recommended study material, and know all there is to know about them instead of reading everything that comes your way.

9) Appear for exam at least one month after the boot camp

There are a number of boot camps that encourage you to take close to a

month before you can do the exam; this does not make any sense at all. You should take the exam as soon as you think you are ready, and this better be soon after you are done with the boot camp. This is because at this time you still have a fresh memory of what you have studied.

10) I perform well when I am worried and in pressure

Everyone gets a bit nervous when taking a test whose credentials are known worldwide therefore you should not think you are the first one. You should learn to control your nerves and be in good shape for you to pass the exam. This will also play a huge role in the way you will attempt and answer the questions.

In the event that you encounter a question that you are not sure of, try and mark it then return to it later on instead of wasting a lot of time on it, and failing to use your time well.

These are a few of the things if you avoid, you will stand a good chance of passing the exam. The most important thing however is that you always have to be well prepared for this and any other exams that you are bound to take. Apart from that, take things seriously, and as usual, your nerves might attempt to get the better of you. What will actually make you pass this exam is how well you can take control of yourself, and how prepared you are for the exam.

CHAPTER

Sure Shot 50 Question Types In The Exam

You probably have gone through a number of test exercises before you go for this exam, and you have a number of questions in mind that you are hoping will be there in the exam for you to attempt. Well, depending on how much revision you have done, you might just strike gold when you open the test.

Going through a lot of questions once you are sure of your understanding of the syllabus content will prepare you for different types of questions that can be set in the exam. Over the years however, there is a system that has been used to examine students, and listed herein are some of the probable question types that you are sure not to miss in the exam. Question is can you attempt them adequately?

Particulars	Total Qs
Do you understand the roles of the project manager, sponsor, and team? Expect at least 5 questions	05
Only around 10 questions where you have to remember the inputs or outputs from the PMBOK Guide	10
There may be around 10 earned-value questions on the exam. Some of these questions may not require you to use formulas to work them out	10
Expect around 10 questions on acronyms like WBS, etc.	10
Around 10-15 questions on PMI-ism on knowledge areas	10
Expect minimum 5 questions on Type of Organizations and Projects	05
Total	50
Surprise Bonus	
There are going to be around 40 questions you cannot answer. Mark them to revisit them during your revision time. If nothing rings a bell, select the answer you are familiar with or you know that it is itself a true statement.	40
Total	90

CHAPTER

23 Dirty Little Tricks During The Exam

I Challenge You Will Not Get This In Any Training Institute

Depending on how much exposure you have with standardized exams, you will have different strategies of approaching them. The PMP exam however is an international exam, and for this reason you can be sure that the kind of security and formality it encompasses can really intimidate you, especially if you are not ready for it.

To complete the exam in good time and also pass it, here are some tricks that you can employ: -

Trick # 1) Memory Dump

Get a scrap paper from your supervisor and put down all the formula you can think of, and any information that you think is necessary for you in this test. This is a good way of getting some stress and pressure off of you.

Here is what you can generally find as part of a PMP Exam Brain Dump:

- Table 3-1 of the A Guide to the Project Management Body of Knowledge (PMBOK Guide) Process Group And KG Mapping
- Formulas, such as earned value, PERT, communication channels, procurement, probability, project selection and depreciation
- Values, such as 1, 2 and 3 sigma and estimate ranges
- Acronyms, such as BAC or TCPI
- Powers of a project manager

- Conflict resolution (best to worst)
- Sources of conflict (order of priority)
- Herzberg's motivators
- Project closing check list

Trick # 2) Know PMBOK

Getting to know the PMBOK is one of the best ways of getting ready for this exam. This is because you will be well in the know about the rules and regulations, and what is covered in the syllabus. Therefore you stand a higher chance of not being shocked or surprised by anything you find in the test. One other thing that you should know is that this exam is not set to be easy, but for those who have worked hard to be able to shine. Therefore get your tactics in check, and have the PMBOK at your fingertips

Trick # 3) Do not eat too much before the test

Eating light is very important because you would not want to have stomach upsets during such an important exam. You will need all the energy you can gather, and all the time possible. Besides that, you are better off knowing that eating heavy will slow you down in terms of pace, and as a matter of fact you can as well fall asleep

Trick # 4) Time your test

Always have the clock in check during this and any other exam. The reason for this is so that you are able to better manage your time, and more so the time you spend on each question. Do not waste so much time on one question since you have a lot more to deal with. If you cannot place any idea on a question, mark it and move on. Remember to answer all questions, if you can't, take an educated guess. This is because all unanswered questions are considered incorrect.

Trick # 5) Stay calm and focused

This is a standardized exam and that you must already be aware of by now. Therefore as you go in, make sure you are well prepared and do not have your mind lingering all over the place. Always try and make sure that you stay focused, and most importantly, ensure that you think positive. Keeping

negative thoughts away can be very important to you achieving success in this exam.

Trick # 6) Read and understand question well

One of the biggest mistakes that so many people do is to hover around a question and jump to an answer. Be a bright student and read the whole question. After all, the time allocated in the exam is in such a way that it is enough for all the questions, and depending on how fast you are, it is even enough to allow you extra time to go over the whole test. Avoid making assumptions, and do not make the mistake of jumping to the answers before you read the question.

Apart from just going over the question and coming up with the right answer, the other thing that you will need to do is to understand what it really entails. This is important in guiding you to the right answer.

Trick # 7) Identify the most important word in the question

Each and every question always has a keyword. It is this that will guide you to finding the right answer. There are those, which require you to define something, while there are also those questions that need a lot more than that. Reading the question and then going over it is a good way of making sure that you do not miss out on any important note. If possible, read the question twice so that you can comprehend what it is looking for. There are also a number of connecting words and conjunctions that can really change the intended meaning of a question, so watch out for these too.

Trick # 8) If you do not know the answer, do not leave it

In the event that you are sitting for a test and you do not know what the question is about, try to make an educated guess, but do not forget to mark it and return to it later on before you are done with the exam. Whether it is a definition or a process related question, all this will go a long way in making sure that you stay on course.

Trick # 9) Read questions like reading a flash card

Do not make the mistake of reading a question and dashing to the answers to find a suitable one. What you should actually do is to try and figure out what the question is about, and come up with an answer first before you can think of checking those already provided. Most importantly, read the question and

understand it!

Trick # 10) Do not jump to conclusion

In as much as you might already know the answer, you should go over all the choices offered in the answer section. By doing this, you might realize that you did not read the question well, depending on the nature of the answers provided.

Trick # 11) Right way of answering scenario questions

When answering a scenario question, here are a few pointers that are sure bound to guide you to getting it right.

- Make sure you understand that last two sentences of the question. This is because in most cases the main keywords to the question are always in this section
- Understand what the question is asking. There are times when the scenario is full of content but they do not mean a thing in relation to the question that you are answering
- Scenario questions typically have a lot of information, most of which you will not need. Therefore learn to know which ones are important and which ones are not.

Trick # 12) Right way of answering problem solving questions

When answering a problem-solving question, never forget the formula. And this is where the formulas you put down on the scrap sheet come in handy. When done, try and go over it to make sure that you are on track.

Trick # 13) Revisit questions in doubt

Once you are done with the test and you have more time, you should go over your work and review the questions wherein you had doubts. Do not second-guess yourself, unless you are so sure about it. This therefore means that you should not change your answers. A lot of people do this, all to their detriment.

Only go back to the questions where you were completely sure you made a guess and not the ones where you answered confidently. This way you can avoid changing the correct answer since in most cases your first instinct is

always the right one. Going over the questions that you were not sure about is one of the surest ways of at least boosting your passing chances.

Trick # 14) Write down question number and the two possible answers

In the event that you are not able to immediately give a correct answer to a question, try and at least note the most possible answers to the question, and then mark the question for review. This way when you come back to it you will have an easier time in selecting only one of two answers, and not one in four.

Trick # 15) Process of elimination

This is one of the most obvious ways of answering a question. If you are not sure about an answer, take it upon yourself to get rid of the obviously wrong ones first then you might narrow down to the correct one, or a choice of two.

Trick # 16) Select the answer, not true statement

There are so many questions that are set with all the true statements in the answer. Such questions need you to pick the right answer, not the right statement. To do this you have to make sure that you get the question right. In most cases these questions are set to confuse you since all of the answers are right, but only one of them answers the question best

Trick # 17) Move On

Never waste time on a question that seems to be a bit difficult for you to crack immediately. Do not forget that there are so many questions still lying in wait for you, and time is running out fast. Mark the hard ones and move on, so that you can come back and review them later on.

Trick # 18) Prefixes and suffixes

Prefixes and suffixes are very important. This is because they go a long way in making sure that you do not just get your question right, but you do understand what it is about. In the event that you are not sure what a word means in the test, a careful study of the prefix or suffix can help you dissect the meaning.

Here are some of the prefixes:

<http://www.englishclub.com/vocabulary/prefixes.htm>

Trick # 19) Hedge Phrases

The exam is set in such a way that there are so many hedge phrases. Remember that questions are always set with only one answer that rules over all the rest. Therefore the examiners are looking for an answer that will not leave any room for doubt or exception. Look out for words like “exactly, mostly, usually, and sometimes” since they go a long way in making sure that you have the right answer.

Trick # 20) Switchback Words

Switchback words like “but, although, and nevertheless” are also very important since they are aimed at alerting you to switch your thought process.

Trick # 21) Check Your Work

Always make sure that you manage your time well enough and ensure that you have enough time to spare to go over the whole exercise. This is important since it will ensure you do not leave around silly mistakes, which will be costly. Going over your work means that you will answer the questions you marked for further review, and also the ones where you did not seem to understand.

Trick # 22) Multiple choice exam

A multiple-choice exam will definitely have more questions than an essay exam. This is because you already have all the answers, and all you have to do is to pick out the correct one. Do not forget that the questions in this exam will not be grouped knowledge areas or process groups. Therefore you have to be ready to find.

Different questions spread all over the test, and this can be confusing at times. Also remember not just to prepare for definitions only, but also the deeper thought process since this will also be tested.

Trick # 23) Real World Questions

The whole idea of a PMP exam is to certify that you are competent when you go out into the real world. Therefore you have to expect a great deal of real life questions, which test your ability to handle things on scene. This would mean that you have learnt a thing or two in the real world, and that you are able to put into use some of the tools that you have learnt before in project management.

CHAPTER

Magic Formula To Solve Multi-Choice Questions In Exam - 8 Step Approach

- 1) First you have to be very confident that you did understand what the question is all about, after that you can check the options given.
- 2) As usually, make sure you read the answers carefully, all of them.
- 3) In the event that the answer does not come to you immediately, you might want to think of getting more clues that can assist aptly in the question.
- 4) Just in case you are still not able to get the right answer quite easily, try and think in terms of eliminating the answers that look so wrong. Best would be to draw table as drawn in chapter “PMP Exam Revision Sheet”.
- 5) The other thing that you can do in the event that you are still not able to hack it is to mark the question and return to it later on. Do not waste precious time.
- 6) You can then revisit the questions that you skipped, and also the ones that you were not so confident about.
- 7) Though it is not always a very good idea to change your answers, if you are so sure about it, then you can go on and change the answer.
- 8) Last but not least, be sure never to leave any question un-answered. Try and attempt all questions to the best of your ability. Even when you are not sure, you can always make an educated guess, and strike gold!

CHAPTER

PMP Exam Revision Table AND TEMPLATE

Use this below table for your practice or draw it before your exam for markings and revisits. This will help you to revisit the questions, which are marked as less confidence or un-marked.

You could use the options as 0, 25, 50, 75, 100% confidence or X (wrong), R (right) or blank (no idea).

Go to next page for revision table:

Exam Revision Table Template

Qs	A	B	C	D	Qs	A	B	C	D	Qs	A	B	C	D	Qs	A	B	C	D
1					51					101					151				
2					52					102					152				
3					53					103					153				
4					54					104					154				
5					55					105					155				
6					56					106					156				
7					57					107					157				
8					58					108					158				
9					59					109					159				
10					60					110					160				
11					61					111					161				
12					62					112					162				
13					63					113					163				
14					64					114					164				
15					65					115					165				
16					66					116					166				
17					67					117					167				
18					68					118					168				
19					69					119					169				
20					70					120					170				
21					71					121					171				
22					72					122					172				
23					73					123					173				
24					74					124					174				
25					75					125					175				
26					76					126					176				
27					77					127					177				
28					78					128					178				
29					79					129					179				
30					80					130					180				
31					81					131					181				
32					82					132					182				
33					83					133					183				
34					84					134					184				
35					85					135					185				
36					86					136					186				
37					87					137					187				
38					88					138					188				
39					89					139					189				
40					90					140					190				
41					91					141					191				
42					92					142					192				
43					93					143					193				
44					94					144					194				
45					95					145					195				
46					96					146					196				
47					97					147					197				
48					98					148					198				
49					99					149					199				
50					100					150					200				

How to use this table:

- 1) Firstly, draw this table before you start the exam on scratch paper. Draw 20 horizontal line and 50 vertical lines. It will take 60 seconds to draw this table before the exam but will help you save 60 minutes in your exam.
- 2) If you are 100% confident in the selected answer, put 100 below the option column. See example. Rest you can leave it blank. Tick the question to make sure you don't have to revisit this question again. You do not have to waste time in revisiting the question where you are 100% confident.

Qs	A	B	C	D
✓ 1				100

- 3) If you are 50% confident, put 50 below the option column. If 25% confident, put 25 below the option column. When you revisit, you are sure that you have to select the answer that has more value. Since you were not 100% sure, that's the reason you are revisiting it. Since it is not ticked, you have to revisit it. During revisit, give a last thought to the answers and then select the answer. Mostly it should be where you are more confident than other answers. If short of time or not sure again which one is the right answer, select the one with the highest value.

Qs	A	B	C	D
2	75	50	25	25

- 4) In below example, you are confident 50% on two answers and on rest you are sure they are incorrect. So this will help you to concentrate on the ones that had higher value and not wasting your time in rereading the answers that were marked as absolutely wrong. If short of time or not sure again which one is the right answer, go with your instinct on any of the 50-50 answer or relate a word from the question.

Qs	A	B	C	D
3	X	50	50	X

- 5) Leave all the columns as blank if you did not understand the question.

Qs	A	B	C	D
4				

Once you have answered the column as 100% in your first attempt, mark the question column as ticked ✓. So you do not have to visit it again and it is easy to determine which one to revisit and which to not which looking at your sheet.

Qs	A	B	C	D
✓5			100	

Or

You have revisit a question and now you have finally decided which one to mark as right answer in the exam, select the answer in exam and just mark tick next to question so you do not have to visit it again.

Qs	A	B	C	D
✓7	25	25	50	50

CHAPTER

How To Crack PMP Exam In 2 ½ Hours

In each and every exam that you might have to encounter in your life, there are a number of tricks that will always get you through. There are those people who will prefer to study hard and smart, while there are also those who will come up with some other methods of making it through the exams. However, one thing that never fails is time management. You may have studied all the books in the world and have all the knowledge possible to pass the exam, but of what use would this be to you if you spend an hour answering a question, yet you have 199 more to go? Therefore time management is the key to success in any exam, and especially PMP exam.

Here's how to crack this one!

1) Know the exam:

It is important that you are well conversant with all the requirements of the exam, especially the rules and regulations. Start with the PMP certification handbook, and then you can find out more from other sources, but be sure not to get confused.

2) Lessons Learned:

Read as many lessons learned message posts at Yahoo, Google group and forums by the PMP's who attempted the exam. Experience is mother of all wisdom. Leverage on the experience of others.

3) Set of questions:

As you answer the questions, you will realize that some of them do require more or less the same information. These might not be arranged in order, so the best way to go about it would be to mark them and refer to them later on since answering one might as well open up a chance for you

to answer the others.

4) Understand the type of question asked:

Once you know the type of question asked, it is very easy and quick to answer the question thus saving lots of time. The biggest single reason people miss questions is that they go too fast and don't read the question carefully and understand what's being asked. Some of the questions are simple definitions of PM terms. About 40 percent of the questions relate to situations (given a set of facts, what would you do?). There are also some questions where you apply your knowledge of commonly used PM formulas. So it is a good idea to understand the type of question asked so you can promptly answer it and move to the next question.

5) Save time by not revisiting the answers you have answered confidently:

Do not waste time going over questions that you are sure you have answered correctly and confidently. As a matter of fact, never attempt to change your answers, unless of course you are sure that they are wrong.

6) Eat light food on the exam day:

Before you go for a test always make sure that you are in sound health and state of mind. This includes eating lightly so that you do not have health related problems that might take your concentration off the test. Never take heavy meals because these have the effect of making you slower and can even induce sleep.

7) Cheat Sheet Dumping:

You will definitely be given some scrap paper with which you are supposed to make relevant use of. Using this paper, transfer all formula and knowledge items that you have in mind and think you might require in the paper before you start the exam. This way you can always refer and also save time during the exam.

8) Monitor the clock so that you can better pace yourself:

Never lose track of time when you are in the exam. For this reason you should remember to monitor the clock at all times, and also ensure that you do not waste time with hard questions. In the event that a question seems to be difficult, the best thing to do would be to mark it and return to it later on.

9) Come up with the answer in your head

If you really want to pass, think up an answer in your head before you look up the choices provided. This way you can avoid being derailed by a wrong answer in the test.

10) Maintain focus and concentration:

Try not to think outside the exam room. You should make sure you pay attention to everything that you are working on in the exam and not anything else that might have happened during the day or something that will happen later on.

11) You will probably have to answer a few technical questions:

In the event that you do not know how to go about such a question, do not waste a lot of time thinking about it, because chances are high you will not make any headway any way. In such a scenario always try and think of relevant clues that can assist you. As a matter of fact you should be fast on realizing that the particular term does not ring an immediate bell and even mark it for later reference.

CHAPTER

Action Items Check List

Initiation

- ☐ Apply for PMI Membership
- ☐ Download PMBOK + AGILE Guide
- ☐ Find training institute
- ☐ Earn 35 Contact Hours
- ☐ Get Training Certificate
- ☐ Register For Exam

Planning

- ☐ Create A Study Plan

Executing

- ☐ Read PMBOK + AGILE
- ☐ Read Cheat sheet
- ☐ Join Yahoo or Google forums/groups
- ☐ Read Exam Material
- ☐ Find online Free/Paid Test and Practice
- ☐ Call Prometric Test Center few weeks before that exam
- ☐ Practice creating memory dump
- ☐ Appear for PMP Exam

Monitoring & Controlling

- ☐ Create/Update Cheat Sheet
- ☐ Create/Practice Test Review Sheet

Closing

- ☐ Add PMP to your signature
- ☐ Laminate Your PMP Certificate
- ☐ Collect CCR to maintain PMP Certification

CHAPTER

Free Online Question Banks And Resources

Below listed are few online links for free access to PMP question banks and resources. As time passes by, some might update their database and some might not. If you find any broken link or outdated material, please let us know so we can change it accordingly.

<http://pmi.org> - Official PMI's Website

<http://pmbootcamp.org> - PMP Question Bank

<http://ezclick.me/pmpbooks> - PMP Books On Amazon

<http://ezclick.me/pducast> - PDUs Pod Cast

<http://ezclick.me/pmformulas> - PM Formulas

<http://ezclick.me/pmpflashcard> - PMP Flash Cards

<http://ezclick.me/pmsimfree> - PM Exam Simulator - 7 Days Trial

<http://ezclick.me/outwit003> - 15 Free Practice Questions

<http://ezclick.me/outwit004> - 20 Free Practice Questions

<http://ezclick.me/outwit015> - 60 Free Practice Questions + Good Resources

<http://ezclick.me/outwit016> - 175 Free Practice Questions

<http://ezclick.me/outwit018> - 100 Free Practice Questions (pm-best.com)

<http://ezclick.me/outwit019> - 200 Free Practice Questions (pmbootcamp.org)

<http://ezclick.me/outwit030> - 200 Free Practice Questions tutorialspoint.com

<http://ezclick.me/outwit040> - 200 Free Practice Questions (pmstudy.com)

<http://ezclick.me/outwit050> - 200 Free Practice Questions (pmstudy.com)

<http://ezclick.me/outwit100> - 260 Free Practice Questions

<http://ezclick.me/outwit130> - 1000 Free Practice Questions

<http://quizlet.com/subject/pmp/> - 3000+ PMP Exam Flash Card

Final Words

So there we have it: simple tricks and tips that will greatly help you to increase your capacity for learning all kinds of facts and figures, no matter how much you've struggled with them up to now. Rest assured that your brain is more than capable of housing the vast swathes of information you need to learn in order to pass your exams: you just have to make it easier for it to absorb more than usual during the busy exam period!

Following the guide in this book will not just guide you through passing the exam, but by and large you could take a few lessons on how to succeed in life. In as much as project management and the PMP exam are considered career-advancing stimuli, there are so many things that you can learn from this experience and apply it in your life. One thing that you should never lose sight of is the fact that your life as it is one of the largest and most demanding projects that you will ever have to be in charge of. Therefore how good a manager can you be? Through this guide therefore there is enough insight to take you through your PMP exam and get that certification you crave so much.

“Concerning all acts of initiative and creation, there is one elementary truth . . . that the moment one definitely commits oneself, then Providence moves too . . . whatever you can do or dream you can, begin it. Boldness has genius, power and magic in it. Begin it now.” – Goethe

For whichever reason, if in case you skimmed all the way to this page, you are justified to do so. However, in the event that you took your time and went through all the pages, you must have realized that the time for you to act is now.

There was a time when empty words like “*knowledge is power*” would soothe the mind. However, things have changed so much today. Knowledge is power only to the extent within which it is aptly applied. This therefore means that unless you act on the knowledge that you possess, it will be of no use to you. Take advantage of the power you have within your grasp now and do something with it.

Sincere thanks to you for taking time to use this book to guide you through

your exam schedule, and even more thanks to the person whose advice you heeded and considered using this book.

Good Luck! And Thank You,

Asif Chorwadwala, PMP,
SSGB <https://www.linkedin.com/in/asifchorwadwala/>

Review/Feedback/Online Game Link

If you enjoyed this book or found it useful I'd be very grateful if you'd post a short review on Amazon. Your support really does make a difference and I read all the reviews personally so I can get your feedback and make this book even better for future PMPs. In this way, you are already giving back to your community.

If you'd like to leave a review then all you need to do is visit the review link on this book's page on Amazon.com: <http://ezclick.me/outwittrevamz6>

Want to have access to 200+ free question and answers as close to the actual PMP exam based on PMBOK 6th Edition, email support@outwittingthepmexam.com with proof of Amazon Review that you have posted online.

For any reason you find this book not worth of giving review of 5 star, please do not hesitate to send me your thoughts, suggestions and feedbacks to support@outwittingthepmexam.com

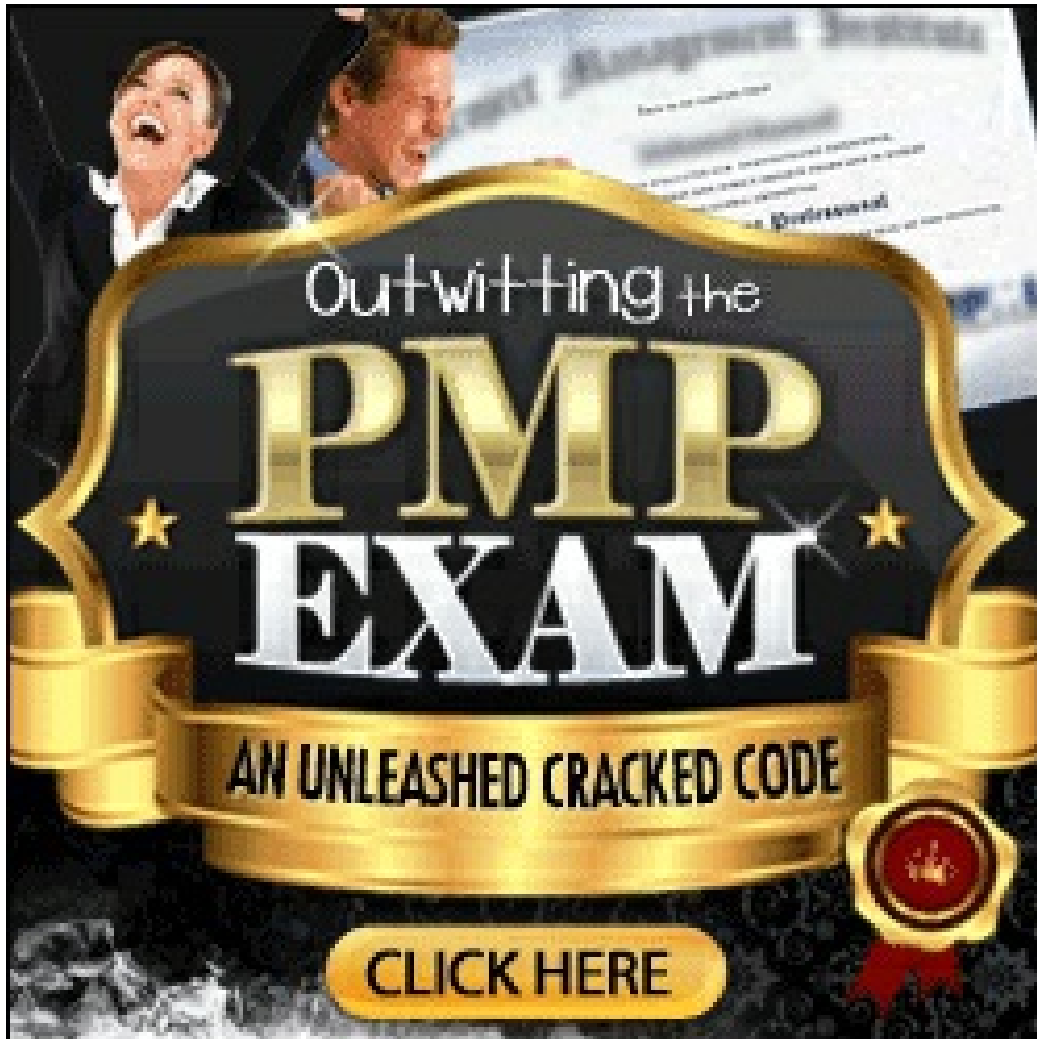
Here is your special bonus link to Rita Mulcahy's Online Process Game: <http://ezclick.me/ritaprogame>

To Download Latest Edition

Over time there will be updates to this book to make it at par with the PMP syllabus requirements. To stay abreast with the latest updates, remember to send email to support@outwittingthepmexam.com with proof of the transaction requesting copy of latest edition of this guide.

**Want to make some passive
income?**

Visit Below Link



<http://outwittingthepmexam.com/affiliate/>

Thank You